QUANTUM IAS & PCS

TATTVA SERIES

UPPSC PRELIMS | FAST REVISION

Medieval History

PYQ-Based Revision Pointers

Chapters 1 to 25

Every pointer comes from an actual UPPSC question · Frequency marks · Year tags
Asked-Most Boxes · Trap Alerts · Quick Tables · Last-Minute 10

© Quantum IAS & PCS. All rights reserved.

Contents

NO.	CHAPTER	POINTERS	PAGE
UNIT I · THE DELHI SULTANATE: DYNASTIES			
01	Muslim Invasion of India	20	4
02	Delhi Sultanate: Slave Dynasty	12	6
03	Khalji Dynasty	15	7
04	Tughluq Dynasty	20	8
05	Sayyid and Lodi Dynasties	6	10
UNIT II · SULTANATE STATE, CULTURE AND REGIONAL KINGDOMS			
06	Vijayanagara Empire	11	11
07	Delhi Sultanate: Administration	13	12
08	Delhi Sultanate: Art and Architecture	5	13
09	Delhi Sultanate: Literature	21	14
10	Delhi Sultanate: Miscellaneous	12	16
11	Provincial Dynasties of North India and the Deccan	20	17
UNIT III · BHAKTI AND SUFI MOVEMENT			
12	Bhakti and Sufi Movement	41	19
UNIT IV · THE GREAT MUGHALS			
13	Mughal Dynasty: Babur	13	21
14	Humayun and Sher Shah	12	22
15	Akbar	27	23
16	Jahangir	12	25
17	Shah Jahan	14	26
18	Aurangzeb	17	27
UNIT V · MUGHAL STATE AND CULTURE			
19	Mughal Administration	19	28
20	Music and Painting in the Mughal Period	14	29
21	Mughal Literature	17	30
22	Mughal Period: Miscellaneous	25	32
UNIT VI · SIKHS, MARATHAS AND MUGHAL DECLINE			
23	Sikh Sect	10	34
24	Maratha State and Confederacy	23	35
25	Disintegration of the Mughal Empire	15	37

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

How to Use This Book

Every pointer is a real question. Each pointer is the answer to a UPPSC question asked between 1990 and 2025, written as a fact you can revise in seconds, with the related fact you need for the next variation.

Frequency marks. ■ and a red count (e.g. 4×) mark a fact asked 3 or more times. • and a gold count mark facts asked once or twice. The years follow; "one-liner" means a short starred question in the source with no year given.

Asked Most box. Each chapter opens with the facts UPPSC repeats most. Revise these first.

Diagrams. Flowcharts and diagrams turn sequences (timelines, procedures, processes, river courses) into one picture.

Trap Alerts. The places where the obvious answer is wrong or two facts are commonly swapped.

Last-Minute 10. The ten lines to read on the morning of the exam.

Pairs with the Masterbook. Use this book for revision after the TATTVA PYQ Masterbook, which has the full questions, options and explanations.

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Chapter 1

Muslim Invasion of India

Built from 22 UPPSC questions (1990–2024). Focus: the Prophet and the Arabs in Sindh, Mahmud of Ghazni and his court scholars, Muhammad Ghori's battles, Bakhtiyar Khalji, and why the Turks won.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **First Muslim invaders**: the **Arabs**; **Muhammad bin Qasim** (an Arab) took Sindh in **712 CE** 4× 1991, 1992, 2002, 2015
- **Muhammad Ghori**: beaten first by **Mularaja II** (Kasahrada, 1178); won **Second Tarain (1192)**; beat **Jayachandra at Chandawar (1194)** 5× 1990, 1995, 2004, 2008, 2016
- **Mahmud's court**: historian **Utbi**; **Al-Biruni** first Muslim to study the Puranas (came in the 11th century) 4× 1991, 2002, 2010, 2014
- **Bakhtiyar Khalji** conquered **Bihar and Bengal** for Ghori 2× 1991, 2018
- Turks won because North India had **no political unity** (A and R true, R explains A) 2× 2018, 2024

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

1.1 The Arabs in Sindh

- Prophet Muhammad born: **570 CE** (Hijra 622) 1× 1996
- First Muslim invaders: **Arabs** 1× 2015
- Muhammad bin Qasim conquered Sindh: **712 CE** 1× 1991
- First Muslim invader: **Muhammad bin Qasim**, an **Arab** 2× 1992, 2002

1.2 Mahmud of Ghazni

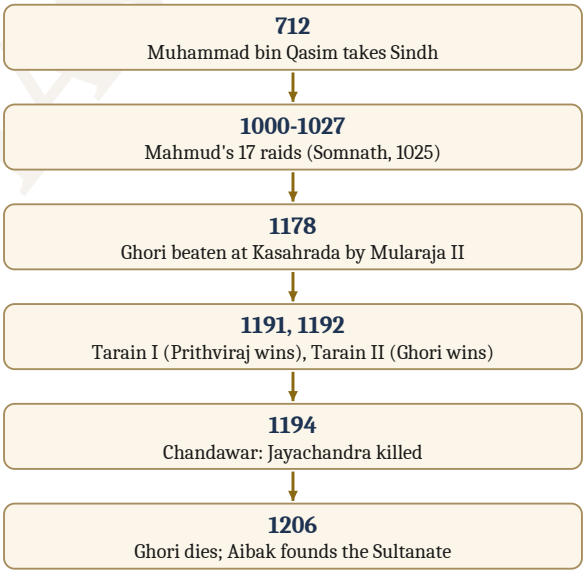
- Ghaznavid founder: **Alptigin** (Sabuktigin in many books) 1× 2015
- Mahmud raided **17 times**, but for **wealth**, not empire (A true, R false) 1× 2004
- Chandela king not defeated by Mahmud (key): **Vidyadhara** 1× 1991
- Silver coins with a Sanskrit legend: **Mahmud of Ghazni** 1× 2000
- Court historian: **Utbi** 1× 1991
- Shahnama author is **Firdausi** (Mahmud's court); the question named Firishta (*) 1× 2013
- First Muslim to study the Puranas: **Al-Biruni** 1× 2002
- Al-Biruni came in the **11th century** 1× 2010
- Not correct of Al-Biruni: a "**secular author**" 1× 2014

Scholar	Work
Al-Biruni	Kitab-ul-Hind (Tahqiq-i-Hind)
Utbi	Tarikh-i-Yamini
Firdausi	Shahnama

1.3 Muhammad Ghori

- Conquered North India in 1192: **Shihabuddin Muhammad Ghori** 1× 2004
- Battle that founded Muslim rule: **Second Battle of Tarain** 1× 1995
- First defeated Ghori: **Mularaja II** (Kasahrada, 1178) 1× 1990
- **Chandawar (1194)**: Ghori beat **Jayachandra** 2× 2008, 2016
- Bihar and Bengal conquered by **Bakhtiyar Khalji** 2× 1991, 2018
- Order: **Mahmud, Ghori, Genghis Khan, Timur** 1× 2008
- Turkish success: North India lacked **political unity** (A and R true, R explains A) 2× 2018, 2024

INVASIONS FROM THE NORTH-WEST



TRAP ALERT

- Hijra = **622**; Prophet's birth = **570**.
- Ghori's first defeat was by **Mularaja II**, not Prithviraj.
- Chandawar (1194) is not the Battle of Kannauj (1540, Sher Shah vs Humayun).
- Shahnama = **Firdausi**, not Firishta.

UP LINK

UP link: **Chandawar** (Firozabad, on the Yamuna) saw Ghori defeat **Jayachandra Gahadavala** of **Kannauj** in 1194; Mahmud raided **Mathura** and **Kannauj** (1018).

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Prophet born 570; Hijra 622
2. Arabs first; Muhammad bin Qasim 712 (Sindh)
3. Alptigin founded the Ghaznavids
4. Mahmud: 17 raids for wealth
5. Utbi = court historian; Firdausi = Shahnama
6. Al-Biruni = Puranas, 11th century
7. Mularaja II beat Ghori first (1178)
8. Second Tarain 1192 = foundation of Muslim rule
9. Chandawar 1194 = Jayachandra
10. Bakhtiyar Khalji = Bihar and Bengal

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Chapter 2

Delhi Sultanate: Slave Dynasty

Built from 14 UPPSC questions (1990–2024). Focus: Aibak and Lahore, Iltutmish and Delhi, Genghis Khan on the Indus, Razia and the Turkish nobles, Balban's kingship.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Iltutmish** made **Delhi** the capital; "slave of a slave"; Genghis Khan came in his reign **10×** 1993, 2002, 2004, 2007, 2010, 2012, 2014, 2016, 2016, 2016
- **Balban**: "**blood and iron**"; centralised power **4×** 2009, 2013, 2014, 2024
- **Razia Sultan**: first woman ruler; removed by the **Turkish** nobles **3×** 2004, 2004, 2010

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice **4×** times asked, followed by the exam years

2.1 Aibak and Iltutmish

- Founder of the Slave dynasty: **Qutbuddin Aibak** **1×** 1990
- Aibak's capital: **Lahore** **1×** 1990
- Made Delhi the capital: **Iltutmish** **5×** 2004, 2012, 2014, 2016, 2016
- First Muslim ruler of Delhi (key): **Iltutmish** (many books say Aibak) **1×** 2002
- "**Slave of a slave**": **Iltutmish** **1×** 2016
- Genghis Khan reached the Indus under **Iltutmish** **3×** 1993, 2007, 2010
- Genghis Khan's original name: **Temujin** **1×** 2015

2.2 Razia and Balban

- First woman ruler: **Razia Sultan** **2×** 2004, 2010
- Razia was overthrown by the **Turkish** nobles (the Forty) **1×** 2004
- "**Blood and iron**": **Balban** **1×** 2009
- Balban centralised power; the reason given does not explain it (A and R true, R does not explain A) **2×** 2013, 2024
- Called himself "helper of the Caliph" at **Garhmukteshwar**: **Balban** **1×** 2014

SLAVE (MAMLUK) DYNASTY

Qutbuddin Aibak (1206-10)
Lahore capital; Lakh Bakhsh; Qutb Minar begun

↓

Iltutmish (1211-36)
Delhi capital; iqta; tanka and jital; Chahalgani

↓

Razia (1236-40)
First woman ruler

↓

Balban (1266-87)
Sijda and paibos; blood and iron; broke the Forty

TRAP ALERT

- Aibak's capital was **Lahore**; Delhi became the capital under **Iltutmish**.
- Genghis Khan came under **Iltutmish** (1221), not Alauddin.
- Razia was removed by **Turkish**, not Afghan, nobles.

UP LINK

UP link: **Garhmukteshwar** (Hapur, on the Ganga) has Balban's inscription calling himself helper of the Caliph; **Badaun** was Iltutmish's iqta before he became Sultan.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Aibak = founder; capital Lahore
2. Iltutmish = Delhi capital; slave of a slave
3. Genghis Khan (Temujin) came under Iltutmish
4. Razia = first woman ruler; ousted by Turks
5. Balban = blood and iron; helper of the Caliph
6. Chahalgani = the Forty (Iltutmish); Balban broke them
7. Iltutmish = silver tanka, copper jital
8. Aibak = Lakh Bakhsh
9. Balban = sijda, paibos
10. Slave dynasty 1206-1290

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Chapter 3

Khalji Dynasty

Built from 15 UPPSC questions (1992–2022). Focus: Alauddin's titles, conquests and their order, Malik Kafur's Deccan raids, the Mongol frontier, land revenue by measurement, new taxes and market control.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Alauddin Khalji's market control** (price control, an early "public distribution system"), highly successful in Delhi 7× 1992, 1998, 2004, 2005, 2010, 2010, 2017
- **Sikandar-i-Sani** (second Alexander) = **Alauddin Khalji**, not Sikandar Lodi 2× 2008, one-liner
- Conquest order: **Gujarat, Ranthambore, Chittor, Warangal** 2× 2022, one-liner
- Alauddin first levied the **ghari** (house tax) and measured land for revenue 2× 1994, 2011

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

3.1 Titles and Conquests

- Title "Alexander the Second": **Alauddin Khalji** 1× 2008
- "Yamin-ul-Khilafat", "Nasir-i-Amir-ul-Mominin": **Alauddin Khalji** 1× one-liner
- Declared himself **Khalifa**: **Mubarak Khalji** 1× 2016
- Order: **Gujarat, Ranthambore, Chittor, Warangal** 1× 2022
- Order (with Jaisalmer): **Jaisalmer, Ranthambore, Chittor, Warangal** 1× one-liner
- **Ranthambore-Hammir Deva, Chittor-Ratan Singh, Devagiri-Ramachandra, Gujarat-Karnadeva** 1× 2017
- Deccan raids were for **wealth**, not annexation (A true, R false) 1× 1997

ALAUDDIN'S CAMPAIGNS

1299
Gujarat (Karnadeva); Somnath looted

↓

1301
Ranthambore (Hammir Deva)

↓

1303
Chittor (Ratan Singh; Padmini legend)

↓

1307-08
Devagiri (Ramachandra) by Malik Kafur

↓

1310-11
Warangal, Dwarasamudra, Madurai

3.2 Army, Revenue and Markets

- Frontier with the Mongols after 1306: the **Ravi** 1× 2014
- Special frontier army: **Alauddin Khalji** 1× 2021
- Revenue by **measuring land** and curbing governors (I and III) 1× 1994
- First **ghari** (house tax): **Alauddin Khalji** 1× 2011
- Price control in Delhi; it was not to cut artisans' wages (A true, R false) 1× 2005
- Strict price control: **Alauddin Khalji** 4× 1992, 1998, 2004, 2010
- Market control was **highly successful** 1× 2017
- Began a "public distribution system": **Alauddin Khalji** 1× 2010

Reform	Detail
Dagh and huliya	Branding horses, descriptive rolls of soldiers
Standing army	Paid in cash
Land revenue	Half the produce; based on measurement
Taxes	Ghari (house), charai (grazing)
Market control	Shahna-i-Mandi; fixed prices in Delhi

TRAP ALERT

- Sikandar-i-Sani = **Alauddin**, despite Sikandar Lodi's name.
- Ghari (house) and charai = Alauddin; haq-i-sharb (irrigation) = **Firuz**.
- Deccan campaigns sought **tribute**, not annexation.
- Order always ends Chittor (1303), then Warangal (1310).

UP LINK

UP link: Alauddin seized power by murdering his uncle **Jalaluddin Khalji at Kara** (Kara-Manikpur, Kaushambi-Pratapgarh) in 1296, funding his rise with the loot of Devagiri.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Alauddin = Sikandar-i-Sani
2. Mubarak Khalji called himself Khalifa
3. Gujarat, Ranthambore, Chittor, Warangal
4. Hammir Deva = Ranthambore; Ratan Singh = Chittor
5. Ramachandra = Devagiri; Karnadeva = Gujarat
6. Deccan raids = wealth, not annexation
7. Mongol frontier = Ravi
8. Ghari = house tax; land measured
9. Market control in Delhi; Shahna-i-Mandi
10. First "public distribution system"

Chapter 4

Tughluq Dynasty

Built from 20 UPPSC questions (1991–2017). Focus: Ghiyasuddin, Muhammad bin Tughluq's projects and Ibn Battuta, Firuz Shah's welfare state and taxes, the Ashokan pillars, Timur's invasion.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

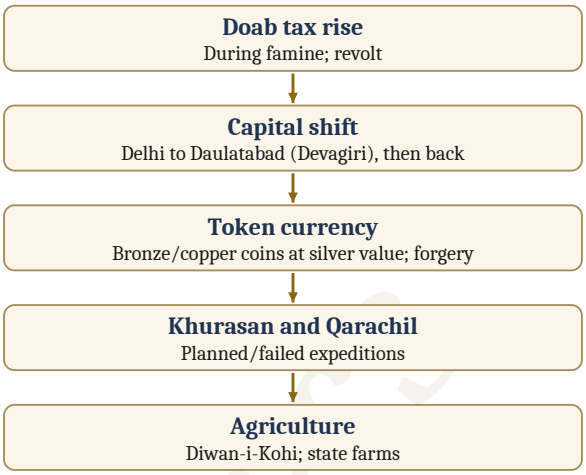
- ■ **Muhammad bin Tughluq**: capital to **Daulatabad**, first **token currency**, the most learned Sultan; **Ibn Battuta** came in his reign **10×** 1991, 1994, 2002, 2004, 2004, 2004, 2006, 2011, 2012, 2017
- ■ **Firuz Shah Tughluq**: employment bureau, public works, translation, Hajj, **Dar-ul-Shifa** **7×** 1998, 2000, 2004, 2006, 2010, 2010, one-liner
- ■ **Haq-i-sharb** (irrigation tax) and **jizya on Brahmins**: **Firuz** **4×** 1996, 2008, 2010, 2011
- • Firuz brought **Ashokan pillars** from **Topra and Meerut** to Delhi **2×** 1996, 2009

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice **4×** times asked, followed by the exam years

4.1 Ghiyasuddin and Muhammad bin Tughluq

- Founder: **Ghazi Malik** (Ghiyasuddin Tughluq) **1×** 1999
- First 14th-century canal builder: **Ghiyasuddin Tughluq** **1×** 2017
- Longest-ruling Sultanate dynasty: **Tughluqs** **1×** 2008
- Most learned Sultan: **Muhammad bin Tughluq** **1×** 2012
- Capital moved to **Daulatabad** **2×** 2002, 2004
- ■ First **token currency**: **Muhammad bin Tughluq** **3×** 2004, 2004, 2017
- Token currency failed: he could not control minting (A and R true, R explains A) **1×** 2006
- ■ **Ibn Battuta** came under **Muhammad bin Tughluq** **3×** 1991, 1994, 2011
- Postal system described by **Ibn Battuta** **1×** 2000
- "The king was freed from his people...": Badauni on **Muhammad bin Tughluq's** death **1×** 2008

MUHAMMAD BIN TUGHLUQ'S PROJECTS



4.2 Firuz Shah Tughluq

- Employment exchange: **Firuz Shah** **2×** 2010, 2010
- Public Works Department: **Firuz Shah** **2×** 2000, 2006
- Translation department: **Firuz Shah** **1×** 2004
- First state-funded Hajj (key): **Firuz Tughluq** **1×** 1998
- **Dar-ul-Shifa**: a **free hospital** **1×** 2013
- First **haq-i-sharb** (irrigation tax): **Firuz** **2×** 2008, 2010
- **Sharb**: a tax on **irrigation** **1×** 1996
- Jizya on Brahmins: **Firuz** **1×** 2011
- Ashokan pillars from **Topra and Meerut**: **Firuz** **2×** 1996, 2009
- Timur came in **1398** under **Nasiruddin Mahmud**; no option correct (*) **1×** 2002

Firuz's department	Work
Diwan-i-Khairat	Charity
Diwan-i-Bandagan	Slaves
Dar-ul-Shifa	Free hospital
Employment bureau	Jobs for the unemployed
Public works	Canals, towns (Jaunpur, Hisar, Firozabad)

TRAP ALERT

- Token currency = Muhammad bin Tughluq; it failed because of **forgery**, not a copper shortage.
- Irrigation tax = **Firuz**; house tax = **Alauddin**.
- Ashokan pillars moved by **Firuz**; the iron pillar is Gupta.
- Timur came in **1398**, after Firuz's death (1388).

UP LINK

UP link: **Jaunpur** was founded by **Firuz Shah Tughluq** (named after Muhammad bin Tughluq, Jauna Khan); the **Meerut** Ashokan pillar he moved now stands in Delhi.

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Ghazi Malik = Ghiyasuddin; first canals
2. Tughluqs ruled longest
3. MBT: Daulatabad, token currency, most learned
4. Ibn Battuta under MBT; described the post
5. Firuz: employment, PWD, translation, Dar-ul-Shifa
6. Haq-i-sharb (irrigation) = Firuz
7. Jizya on Brahmins = Firuz
8. Topra and Meerut pillars to Delhi = Firuz
9. Firuz founded Jaunpur, Hisar, Firozabad
10. Timur 1398 (Nasiruddin Mahmud)

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Chapter 5

Sayyid and Lodi Dynasties

Built from 6 UPPSC questions (1993–2023). Focus: the Sayyid order, the Lodis as the only Afghan dynasty, Sikandar Lodi and Agra, and the order of the five Sultanate dynasties.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

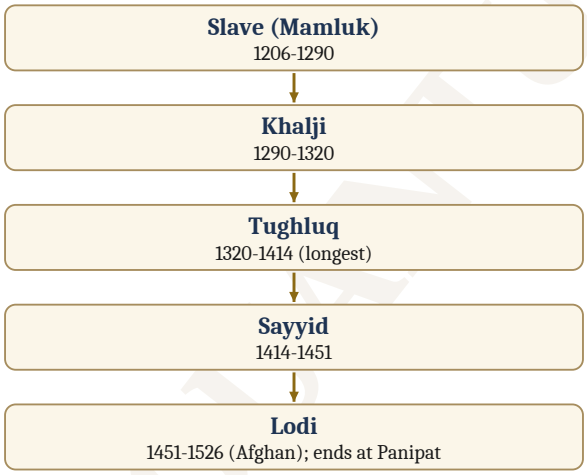
- ■ **Agra** founded by **Sikandar Lodi** (1504) 7× 1993, 2004, 2005, 2008, 2010, 2011, 2011
- ■ **Lodis** = the only **Afghan** Sultanate dynasty 4× 1993, 2008, 2011, 2016
- • Order: **Slave, Khalji, Tughluq, Sayyid, Lodi** 1× 2012

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

5.1 Sayyids and Lodis

- • Sayyid order: **Khizr Khan, Mubarak Shah, Muhammad Shah, Alauddin Alam Shah** 1× 2023
- ■ Afghan origin: **Lodis** 4× 1993, 2008, 2011, 2016
- ■ Agra founded by **Sikandar Lodi** 7× 1993, 2004, 2005, 2008, 2010, 2011, 2011
- • Pen-name "**Gulrukhi**": **Sikandar Lodi** 1× 2015
- • Abolished the tax on grain: **Sikandar Lodi** 1× 2010
- • Order: **Slave, Khalji, Sayyid, Lodi** (4, 1, 3, 2) 1× 2012

DELHI SULTANATE DYNASTIES



Lodi Sultan	Note
Bahlul Lodi	Founder; bahloli coin
Sikandar Lodi	Founded Agra (1504); gaz-i-Sikandari; Gulrukhi
Ibrahim Lodi	Killed by Babur at Panipat (1526)

TRAP ALERT

- The Khaljis were Turks; only the **Lodis** were Afghans.
- Agra = **Sikandar Lodi**, not Firuz Tughluq.
- Sayyid order: Mubarak Shah comes **before** Muhammad Shah.

UP LINK

UP link: **Agra** was founded in 1504 by **Sikandar Lodi**, who made it his capital; the Lodis also fought the **Sharqi** sultans of **Jaunpur**, whom Bahlul Lodi ended.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Khizr Khan founded the Sayyids
2. Khizr, Mubarak, Muhammad, Alam Shah
3. Lodis = only Afghan dynasty
4. Bahlul Lodi = founder
5. Sikandar Lodi = Agra (1504)
6. Gulrukhi = Sikandar Lodi's pen-name
7. Sikandar abolished the grain tax
8. Gaz-i-Sikandari = his measuring yard
9. Ibrahim Lodi lost at Panipat, 1526
10. Slave, Khalji, Tughluq, Sayyid, Lodi

Chapter 6

Vijayanagara Empire

Built from 11 UPPSC questions (1993–2016). Focus: Sayana and the Sangamas, Ganga Devi, Krishnadeva Raya and the Ashtadiggajas, foreign travellers, Talikota and Hampi.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- ■ **Krishnadeva Raya**: golden age of **Telugu**; **Ashtadiggajas** = eight Telugu poets; founded **Nagalapura** 4× 2001, 2006, 2008, 2016
- • **Talikota (1565)**: Vijayanagara vs **Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golconda** (and Bidar) 2× 1993, 2014
- • **Hampi** = ruins of the capital 2× 2007, 2008

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

6.1 Foundation and Literature

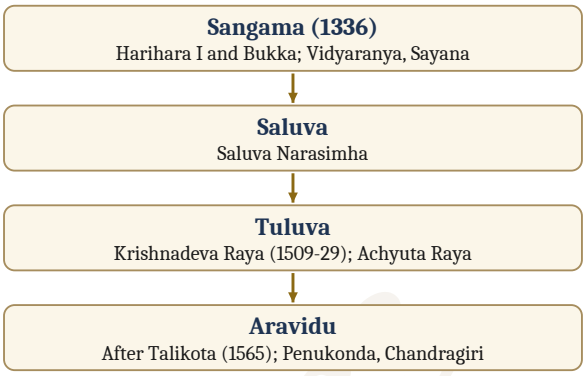
- **Sayana** (Vedic commentator): patronised by **Vijayanagara** rulers 1× 2008
- **Madhura Vijayam** (husband's victories): **Ganga Devi** 1× 2000
- **Ashtadiggajas**: **eight Telugu poets** of Krishnadeva Raya 1× 2001
- Krishnadeva Raya's age: golden age of **Telugu** 1× 2006
- Enthroned about 500 years before 2008: **Krishnadeva Raya** (1509) 1× 2008
- City founded by Krishnadeva Raya: **Nagalapura** 1× 2016
- Telugu translators: **Nannaya and Tikkana** (3 and 4) 1× 2012

6.2 Travellers, Talikota and Hampi

- **Abdur Razzaq** came under **Deva Raya II** 1× 2010
- **Talikota**: Vijayanagara vs **Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golconda** 1× 2014
- Talikota fought in **1565** 1× 1993
- Old capital ruins: **Hampi** 2× 2007, 2008

Traveller	Ruler	Origin
Nicolo Conti	Deva Raya I	Italy
Abdur Razzaq	Deva Raya II	Persia
Domingo Paes	Krishnadeva Raya	Portugal
Fernao Nuniz	Achyuta Raya	Portugal
Athanasius Nikitin	Bahmani kingdom	Russia

FOUR DYNASTIES OF VIJAYANAGARA



TRAP ALERT

- Ashtadiggajas = **poets**; Ashtapradhan = Shivaji's **ministers**.
- Abdur Razzaq = **Deva Raya II**; Paes = Krishnadeva Raya.
- Talikota was against the **Deccan sultanates**, not the Bahmanis (already split).

UP LINK

UP link: **Harihara and Bukka** had served Muhammad bin Tughluq of Delhi before founding Vijayanagara in 1336, during the same revolts that hit the Doab and Awadh.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Founded 1336 by Harihara and Bukka
2. Sayana = Vijayanagara patronage
3. Ganga Devi = Madhura Vijayam
4. Krishnadeva Raya = Telugu golden age
5. Ashtadiggajas = eight Telugu poets
6. Nagalapura founded by Krishnadeva Raya
7. Abdur Razzaq = Deva Raya II
8. Paes = Krishnadeva; Nuniz = Achyuta
9. Talikota 1565 vs Deccan sultanates
10. Hampi = capital ruins

Chapter 7

Delhi Sultanate: Administration

Built from 15 UPPSC questions (1991–2025). Focus: the Turkish nobility, the wazir and zawabit, khalisa and iqta, departments set up by individual Sultans, tanka and jital.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Iqta** system introduced by **Iltutmish**; iqta revenue was **not** paid straight to the Sultan 3× 2010, 2019, 2023
- **Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi** = **agriculture** department of **Muhammad bin Tughluq** 4× 1997, 2004, 2017, 2017
- **Tanka** (silver) and **jital** (copper) = main Sultanate coins; started by **Iltutmish** 3× 2001, 2008, 2013

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

7.1 Nobility, Ministries and Law

- Most Sultans and amirs were **Turkish** 1× 1991
- **Wizarat** peaked under the **Tughluqs** 1× 1997
- **Zawabit**: **state laws** 1× 1997
- **Kharitadar**: **dispatcher of royal decrees** 1× 2023

7.2 Land and Departments

- Land was **khalisa** and iqta (jagir); khalisa, not jagir, was state land (A true, R false) 1× 2025
- Not an iqta feature: revenue paid **straight to the Sultan** 1× 2019
- **Iqta** system: **Iltutmish** 1× 2010
- **Iqta-land revenue, Mahrusa-protected town, Khalisa-state land, Shiq-a portion** 1× 2023
- Wrong pair: **Diwan-i-Riyasat-Balban** (it was Alauddin's market department) 1× 2008

■ **Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi**: **Muhammad bin Tughluq**; **agriculture** 4× 1997, 2004, 2017, 2017

Department	Work	Founder
Diwan-i-Arz	Army	Balban
Diwan-i-Riyasat	Markets	Alauddin Khalji
Diwan-i-Mustakhraj	Arrears of revenue	Alauddin Khalji
Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi	Agriculture	Muhammad bin Tughluq
Diwan-i-Khairat	Charity	Firuz Tughluq
Diwan-i-Bandagan	Slaves	Firuz Tughluq

7.3 Coinage

- Main coins: **jital and tanka** (2 and 4) 1× 2001
- Silver **tanka** started by **Iltutmish** 2× 2008, 2013
- Last Baghdad Caliph's name first on coins of **Alauddin Masud Shah** 1× 2012

TRAP ALERT

- Mansabdari is **Mughal**; the Sultanate used **iqta**.
- Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi = agriculture, not hills or forests.
- Diwan-i-Riyasat = **Alauddin**, not Balban.

UP LINK

UP link: **Awadh, Kara, Badaun** and **Sambhal** were major iqtas of the Sultanate in present UP; Iltutmish himself held **Badaun** before becoming Sultan.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Sultans and nobles mostly Turkish
2. Wizarat peaked under the Tughluqs
3. Zawabit = state laws; Kharitadar = royal dispatches
4. Khalisa = crown land; iqta = assigned revenue
5. Iltutmish = iqta system, tanka
6. Diwan-i-Arz = Balban; Diwan-i-Riyasat = Alauddin
7. Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi = MBT, agriculture
8. Tanka silver; jital copper
9. Mahrusa = protected town; shiq = portion
10. Masud Shah = last Caliph's name on coins

Chapter 8

Delhi Sultanate: Art and Architecture

Built from 5 UPPSC questions (2002–2022). Focus: the first Indo-Islamic tomb, the Qutb Minar's builders, early Sultanate monuments, Aibak's mosques at Delhi and Ajmer.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- ■ **Qutb Minar**: begun by **Aibak**, raised by **Iltutmish**, fifth storey by **Firuz Tughluq**; **Alauddin** did not build it 4× 2002, 2003, 2004, 2013
- • **Sultan Ghari-Iltutmish, Red Palace-Balban, Jamaat Khana Masjid-Alauddin, Adhai Din ka Jhonpra-Aibak** 1× 2022

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

8.1 Monuments

- First Indo-Islamic tomb (key): **Balban's tomb** (first true arch) 1× 2004
- ■ Did not build the Qutb Minar: **Alauddin Khalji** 3× 2002, 2003, 2013
- Fifth storey: **Firuz Shah Tughluq** 1× 2004
- **Sultan Ghari-Iltutmish, Red Palace-Balban, Jamaat Khana Masjid-Alauddin Khalji, Adhai Din ka Jhonpra-Aibak** 1× 2022
- Wrong pair: **Ajmer-Quwwat-ul-Islam** (that is Delhi; Ajmer has the Adhai Din ka Jhonpra) 1× 2011

Monument	Builder
Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque (Delhi)	Aibak
Adhai Din ka Jhonpra (Ajmer)	Aibak
Qutb Minar	Aibak, Iltutmish, Firuz (repairs)
Sultan Ghari	Iltutmish
Alai Darwaza, Siri	Alauddin Khalji
Tughlaqabad	Ghiyasuddin Tughluq
Atala Masjid (Jaunpur)	Sharqis

TRAP ALERT

- Alauddin built the **Alai Darwaza** and began the unfinished Alai Minar, not the Qutb Minar.
- Delhi = Quwwat-ul-Islam; Ajmer = Adhai Din ka Jhonpra.
- Balban's tomb has the first **true arch**.

UP LINK

UP link: the Sharqi sultans built the **Atala, Jhanjhri and Jama mosques** in **Jaunpur**, the finest regional Sultanate style in UP.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Balban's tomb = first true arch
2. Qutb Minar: Aibak, Iltutmish, Firuz
3. Alauddin not a Qutb Minar builder
4. Sultan Ghari = Iltutmish
5. Red Palace = Balban
6. Jamaat Khana Masjid = Alauddin
7. Adhai Din ka Jhonpra = Aibak (Ajmer)
8. Quwwat-ul-Islam = Aibak (Delhi)
9. Alai Darwaza = Alauddin
10. Atala Masjid = Jaunpur (Sharqi)

QUANTUM IAS &

Chapter 9

Delhi Sultanate: Literature

Built from 24 UPPSC questions (1990–2023). Focus: Amir Khusrau, Amir Hasan, Persian translations, the chroniclers of the Sultanate and their books, regional histories and Hindavi poetry.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Amir Khusrau**: born at **Patiali** (Etah then, Kasganj now); "**Parrot of India**"; court poet of **Alauddin**; father of **Khari Boli**; first Persian poet to describe India **10×** 1990, 1995, 2002, 2002, 2003, 2005, 2008, 2012, 2013, 2017
- **Chronicler-book matching**: **Barani-Tarikh-i-Firozshahi and Fatawa-i-Jahandari, Hasan Nizami-Taj-ul-Maasir, Minhaj-Tabaqat-i-Nasiri, Yahya-Tarikh-i-Mubarakshahi, Isami-Futuh-us-Salatin, Khusrau-Khazain-ul-Futuh** **4×** 1997, 2009, 2019, 2023
- **Amir Hasan Sijzi** = "Sadi of India"; compiled **Fawaid-ul-Fuad** (Nizamuddin Auliya's talks) **2×** 2013, 2021

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice **4×** times asked, followed by the exam years

9.1 Amir Khusrau and Amir Hasan

- Khusrau born at **Patiali** (Etah in 2002-03; now Kasganj) (*) **3×** 2002, 2003, one-liner
- "**Parrot of India**": **Amir Khusrau** **1×** 2013
- Court poet of **Alauddin Khalji** **1×** 1995
- Saw seven Sultans: **Amir Khusrau** and Nizamuddin both fit (*) **1×** 2005
- Father of Hindi **Khari Boli**; master of Hindi and Persian **4×** 1990, 2002, 2008, 2012
- First Persian poet to depict India: **Amir Khusrau** **1×** 2017
- **Tabla** introduced by **Amir Khusrau** (tradition) **1×** 2009
- "Sadi of India": **Amir Hasan** **1×** 2013
- **Fawaid-ul-Fuad**: compiled by **Amir Hasan Sijzi** **1×** 2021

9.2 Translations and Chronicles

- Shukasaptati into Persian as **Tutinama**: **Ziya-uddin Nakhshabi** **1×** 2022
- Translated Firuz's 300 Nagarkot volumes: **Azizuddin Khan** (per key) **1×** 2023
- **Futuh-us-Salatin-Isami, Futuhat-i-Firozshahi-Firuz, Tarikh-i-Firozshahi-Barani, Khazain-ul-Futuh-Khusrau** **1×** 2023
- Sultan who wrote his memoirs: **Firuz Tughluq** **1×** 2008
- **Barani-Tarikh-i-Firozshahi, Hasan Nizami-Taj-ul-Maasir, Minhaj-Tabaqat-i-Nasiri, Yahya-Tarikh-i-Mubarakshahi** **1×** 1997
- **Taj-ul-Maasir-Hasan Nizami, Khazain-ul-Futuh-Khusrau, Tarikh-i-Mubarakshahi-Yahya, Fatawa-i-Jahandari-Barani** **1×** 2019
- **Tarikh-i-Hind-Al-Biruni, Tarikh-i-Delhi-Khusrau, Rihla-Ibn Battuta, Tabaqat-i-Nasiri-Minhaj** **1×** 2009
- Order: **Kitab-ul-Hind, Prithviraj Raso, Tabaqat-i-Nasiri, Fatawa-i-Jahandari** **1×** 2020

Book	Author
Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	Minhaj-us-Siraj
Taj-ul-Maasir	Hasan Nizami
Tarikh-i-Firozshahi, Fatawa-i-Jahandari	Ziauddin Barani
Futuhat-i-Firozshahi	Firuz Shah Tughluq
Futuh-us-Salatin	Isami
Khazain-ul-Futuh, Tughlaqnama	Amir Khusrau
Tarikh-i-Mubarakshahi	Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi
Rihla	Ibn Battuta

9.3 Regional Histories and Hindavi

- **Mirat-i-Sikandari** (Gujarat), **Burhan-i-Maasir** (Bahmanis), **Riyaz-us-Salatin** (Bengal), **Riyaz-ul-Insha** (Mahmud Gawan's letters) **1×** 2023
- Mirat-i-Sikandari describes Mahmud Begada's prosperity and security (both) **1×** 2023
- **Mulla Daud-Chandayan, Damodar-Padmavati Katha, Somnath-Raga Vibodh, Khusrau-Ashiqa** **1×** 2019
- Jain scholar among options: **Hemachandra Suri** **1×** 2009

TRAP ALERT

- Futuh-us-Salatin (**Isami**) vs Futuhat-i-Firozshahi (**Firuz**).
- Fatawa-i-Jahandari is **Barani's**, not Firuz's.
- Amir Hasan Sijzi (Sufi poet) is not Hasan Nizami (Aibak's historian).
- Patiali was in Etah until 2008; it is now **Kasganj**.

UP LINK

UP link: **Amir Khusrau** was born at **Patiali** (now Kasganj district, UP) in 1253; **Mulla Daud's Chandayan** (1379) was written at **Dalmau** (Rae Bareli), the first Sufi masnavi in Awadhi.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Khusrau = Patiali, Parrot of India, Alauddin's poet
2. Khusrau = Khari Boli; tabla by tradition
3. Amir Hasan = Sadi of India; Fawaid-ul-Fuad
4. Nakhshabi = Tutinama
5. Barani = Tarikh-i-Firozshahi, Fatawa-i-Jahandari
6. Hasan Nizami = Taj-ul-Maasir; Minhaj = Tabaqat-i-Nasiri
7. Isami = Futuh-us-Salatin; Firuz = Futuhat (memoirs)
8. Yahya = Tarikh-i-Mubarakshahi
9. Mirat-i-Sikandari = Gujarat; Burhan-i-Maasir = Bahmani
10. Mulla Daud = Chandayan

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Chapter 10

Delhi Sultanate: Miscellaneous

Built from 12 UPPSC questions (1997–2021). Focus: Turkish court life, crops, ruler-measure matching, the order of travellers and rulers, battles and their dates.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Ruler-measure matching: Firuz-canals, Balban-Nauroz, Alauddin-Diwan-i-Riyasat, Jahangir-Thomas Roe; Akbar-Ain-i-Dahsala, MBT-token currency, Iltutmish-Chahalgani, Sher Shah-Sarak-i-Azam** 2× 1997, 1997
- **Battle-year matching: Chandawar 1194, Timur 1398, Ghaghra 1529, Talikota 1565; Kalinga 261 BCE, Tarain 1192, Haldighati 1576, Plassey 1757** 3× 2002, 2003, 2017

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

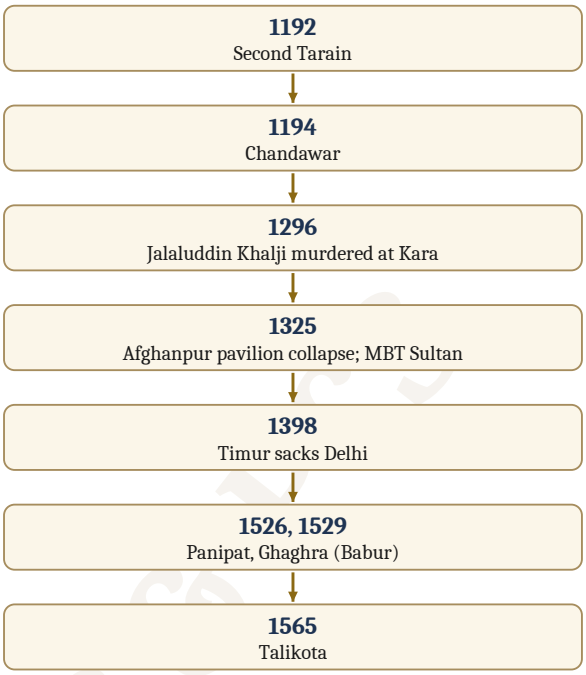
10.1 Court, Society and Crops

- **Polo** introduced by the **Turks** 1× 2001
- **Dastar-bandan**: the **ulema** 1× 2014
- Hindu gods worshipped in the palace: **Nasiruddin Khusrau Shah** 1× 2021
- Not grown in the 13th-14th centuries: **maize** (a New World crop) 2× 2008, 2011

10.2 Matching and Order

- **Firuz-canals, Balban-Nauroz, Alauddin-Diwan-i-Riyasat, Jahangir-Thomas Roe** 1× 1997
- **Akbar-Ain-i-Dahsala, MBT-token currency, Iltutmish-Chahalgani, Sher Shah-Sarak-i-Azam** 1× 1997
- Wrong pair: **Abdur Razzaq-Turkey** (he was **Persian**) 1× 2017
- Order: **Al-Biruni, Ibn Battuta, Tavernier, Manucci** 2× 1997, 2002
- Order: **Razia, Alauddin, Sher Shah, Akbar** 1× 2010
- Order: **Second Tarain, murder of Jalaluddin, Afghanpur conspiracy, capital transfer** 1× 2017
- **Chandawar-1194, Timur-1398, Talikota-1565, Ghaghra-1529** 1× 2017
- **Plassey-1757, Kalinga-261 BCE, Haldighati-1576, Tarain-1192** 2× 2002, 2003

KEY DATES OF THE PERIOD



TRAP ALERT

- Maize, tobacco, potato, chillies came from the Americas after 1500.
- Abdur Razzaq was Persian (from Herat), not Turkish.
- "Tarain" with no number means the **second** battle, 1192.

UP LINK

UP link: the **Battle of Ghaghra** (1529), where Babur beat the Afghans and the Bengal Sultan, was fought on the Ghaghra in eastern UP (Ballia region); **Chandawar** (1194) is near Firozabad.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Turks brought polo
2. Dastar-bandan = ulema
3. Khusrau Shah allowed Hindu worship in the palace
4. No maize before 1500
5. Balban = Nauroz; Firuz = canals
6. Iltutmish = Chahalgani; Sher Shah = Sarak-i-Azam
7. Al-Biruni, Ibn Battuta, Tavernier, Manucci
8. Chandawar 1194; Timur 1398
9. Ghaghra 1529; Talikota 1565
10. Haldighati 1576; Plassey 1757

QUANTUM IAS

Chapter 11

Provincial Dynasties of North India and the Deccan

Built from 24 UPPSC questions (1995–2023). Focus: Zain-ul-Abidin of Kashmir, the Sharqis of Jaunpur, Rana Kumbha, the Bahmanis and Deccan sultanates, provincial architecture, southern kingdoms and officer titles.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Jaunpur**: founded by **Firuz Tughluq** in memory of **Muhammad bin Tughluq**; "**Shiraz of India**" (a centre of learning); last ruler **Hussain Shah** 9× 2001, 2002, 2003, 2004, 2004, 2005, 2006, 2017, 2023
- **Rana Kumbha**: built the victory tower (Kirti/Vijay Stambh) at **Chittor**; wrote on **music** 4× 2007, 2008, 2010, 2011
- **Bahmani kingdom**: **1347**, founded by **Hasan Gangu**; **Adil Shahi-Bijapur, Qutb Shahi-Golconda, Nizam Shahi-Ahmadnagar** 4× 1995, 2002, 2004, 2005
- **Southern capitals**: **Hoysala-Dwarasamudra (Halebid), Yadava-Devagiri, Kakatiya-Warangal, Pandya-Madurai** 6× 2003, 2003, 2008, 2014, 2018, 2019

■ asked 3 or more times · asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

11.1 Kashmir, Jaunpur and Mewar

- Abolished jizya and cow slaughter in Kashmir: **Zain-ul-Abidin** (real name **Shahi Khan**) 2× 2023, one-liner
- Jaunpur founded in memory of **Muhammad bin Tughluq**, by **Firuz Shah Tughluq** 4× 2002, 2003, 2004, 2006
- "**Shiraz of India**": **Jaunpur** 3× 2001, 2004, 2005
- Jaunpur was "Shiraz-i-Hind" as a great centre of learning (A and R true, R explains A) 1× 2023
- Last ruler of Jaunpur: **Hussain Shah** Sharqi 1× 2017
- Wrong pair: **Malik Sarwar Khwaja Jahan-Malwa** (he founded the Jaunpur Sharqi state) 1× 2021
- Victory tower of Chittor: **Rana Kumbha** 3× 2008, 2010, 2011
- Rajput ruler who wrote on music: **Rana Kumbha** 1× 2007

11.2 The Deccan

- Bahmani kingdom: **1347**, founder **Hasan Gangu** (Alauddin Bahman Shah) 2× 1995, 2005
- **Adil Shahi-Bijapur, Qutb Shahi-Golconda, Nizam Shahi-Ahmadnagar, Sharqi-Jaunpur** 1× 2002
- **Kitab-i-Nauras**: **Ibrahim Adil Shah II** 1× 2020
- Wrong pair: **Yusuf Adil Shah-Ahmadnagar** (he founded Bijapur) 1× 2004

Deccan sultanate	Capital	Dynasty
Bijapur	Bijapur	Adil Shahi
Ahmadnagar	Ahmadnagar	Nizam Shahi
Golconda	Golconda	Qutb Shahi
Berar	Ellichpur	Imad Shahi
Bidar	Bidar	Barid Shahi

11.3 Architecture, the South and Officers

- Wrong pair: **Adina Masjid-Mandu** (it is at **Pandua**, Bengal) 1× 2018
- **Atala Masjid-Ibrahim Shah Sharqi, Chhota Sona Masjid-Wali Muhammad, Qadam Rasul-Nusrat Shah, Adina Masjid-Sikandar Shah** 1× 2021
- Correct: **Hoysala-Dwarasamudra**, Pandya-Madurai 2× 2003, 2008
- **Pallava-Kanchi, Pandya-Madurai, Yadava-Devagiri, Kakatiya-Warangal** 1× 2019
- Wrong pair: **Warangal-Ramachandra Dev** (Ramachandra ruled Devagiri) 1× 2018
- **Dwarasamudra** = modern **Halebid**; capital of the **Hoysalas** 2× 2003, 2014
- **Polygars**: territorial **administrative and military** chiefs 1× 2015
- **Talar-night guard, Pattakila-village tax collector, Sahasadhipati-dacoity officer, Baladhipa-octroi guard** 1× 2022

TRAP ALERT

- Jaunpur founder = **Firuz**; Sharqi state founder = **Malik Sarwar** (Khwaja Jahan).
- Zain-ul-Abidin **abolished** jizya; Sikandar Shah (Kashmir) imposed it.
- Yadava = **Devagiri**; Kakatiya = **Warangal** (often swapped).
- Adina Masjid = **Pandua** (Bengal), not Mandu.

UP LINK

UP link: the **Sharqi Sultanate of Jaunpur** (1394-1479) was UP's great medieval regional state; its **Atala Masjid** and **Jama Masjid**, and its fame as the "Shiraz of India", come from Ibrahim Shah Sharqi's patronage of learning.

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Zain-ul-Abidin (Shahi Khan) = Budshah of Kashmir
2. Jaunpur = Firuz, for MBT; Shiraz of India
3. Malik Sarwar founded the Sharqis; Hussain Shah the last
4. Rana Kumbha = Chittor tower, music treatise
5. Bahmani 1347; Hasan Gangu
6. Bijapur = Adil Shahi; Golconda = Qutb Shahi; Ahmadnagar = Nizam Shahi
7. Ibrahim Adil Shah II = Kitab-i-Nauras
8. Atala Masjid = Ibrahim Sharqi; Adina = Sikandar Shah (Pandua)
9. Dwarasamudra = Halebid (Hoysala)
10. Polygars = military chiefs in the south

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Chapter 12

Bhakti and Sufi Movement

Built from 49 UPPSC questions (1990–2025). Focus: Alvars and the acharyas, Ramananda and Kabir, the order of saints, Namdev, Chaitanya and Shankaradeva, Tulsidas, the Chishti chain and dargahs, other silsilas.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Acharya-philosophy matching**: **Ramanuja-Vishishtadvaita, Madhva-Dvaita, Nimbarka-Dvaitadvaita, Vallabha-Shuddhadvaita** 5× 1991, 2002, 2005, 2017, 2022
- **Chishti chain**: **Usman Haruni, Muinuddin (Ajmer), Bakhtiyar Kaki, Farid, Nizamuddin (Delhi, Mahbub-i-Ilahi), Nasiruddin (Chirag-i-Delhi)** 10× 2002, 2006, 2007, 2010, 2014, 2014, 2014, 2014, 2017, 2020
- **Ramananda**: born at **Prayag**; Kabir's guru; "let no man ask a man's caste" 3× 2002, 2009, 2010
- **Shankaradeva** spread Vaishnavism in **Assam**; Chaitanya = Vaishnava 4× 1990, 2002, 2011, 2015
- **Naqshbandis** opposed music 3× 2002, 2003, 2013

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

12.1 Origins and the Acharyas

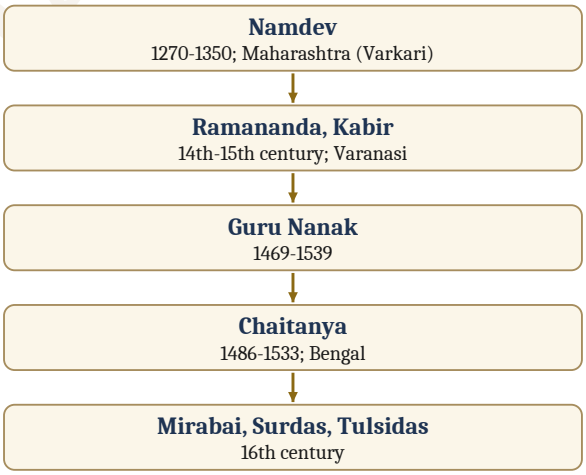
- Bhakti started by the **Alvars** 1× 2001
- Revived in the North in the **15th-16th centuries** 1× 1993
- **Ramanuja**: **Vishishtadvaita**; followers are **Vaishnavas** 2× 1991, 1999
- **Shuddhadvaita**: **Vallabhacharya** 1× 2002
- Correct: **Dvaita-Madhvacharya** 1× 2005
- Acharya-philosophy match (A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4 per key) 1× 2017
- **Ramanuja-Vishishtadvaita, Madhva-Dvaita, Nimbarka-Dvaitadvaita, Vallabha-Shuddhadvaita** 1× 2022

Acharya	Philosophy
Shankara	Advaita
Ramanuja	Vishishtadvaita
Madhva	Dvaita
Nimbarka	Dvaitadvaita
Vallabha	Shuddhadvaita

12.2 Northern Saints

- Born at **Prayag**: **Ramananda** 1× 2010
- "Let no man ask a man's sect or caste": **Ramananda** 1× 2009
- Kabir's guru: **Ramananda** 1× 2002
- Kabir-Dharamdas dialogues: **Amarmool** 2× 2002, 2003
- **Kabir-Ramananda, Khusrau-Nizamuddin, Surdas-Vallabhacharya, Mardana-Guru Nanak** 1× 2025
- Order: **Kabir, Nanak, Chaitanya, Mirabai** 1× 2014
- Order: **Namdev, Kabir, Nanak, Chaitanya** 1× 2025
- Order: **Namdev, Kabir, Nanak, Mirabai** 1× 2005
- Mirabai's contemporaries: several fit (*) 1× 1995
- Nanak's successor: **Guru Angad** 1× 2023
- Varkari saint: **Namdev** 2× 2002, 2004
- Influenced by Islam: **Namdev** 1× 2010
- **Chaitanya**: **Vaishnava** 1× 1990
- Vaishnavism in Assam (Kamarupa, Cooch Bihar): **Shankaradeva** 3× 2002, 2011, 2015
- Tulsidas: born at Rajapur (now **Chitrakoot**); wife **Ratnavali** (neither statement) 1× 2023
- Tulsidas: contemporary of **Akbar and Jahangir** 1× 2004
- **Malukdas**: saint-poet of **Kara** 1× 2008
- Wrong pair: **Raskhan-Rasikpriya** (Rasikpriya = Keshavdas) 1× 2018

ORDER OF THE BHAKTI SAINTS



12.3 Sufism

- Not related to Sufism: **ulema** 1× 2014
- Sufis: **Nizamuddin Auliya, Muinuddin Chishti** (2 and 3) 1× 1998
- Sanskrit music works were translated into Persian; sama is true but not the reason (A and R true, R does not explain A) 1× 2018
- Chishti order in India: **Khwaja Muinuddin** (Ajmer) 2× 2002, 2014
- Chishti order's founder (abroad): **Khwaja Abu Abdal** 1× 2011
- Muinuddin's guru: **Usman Haruni** 2× 2014, 2014
- Baba **Farid** in the **Adi Granth** 1× 1994

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

- Nizamuddin's dargah: **Delhi**; his guru: **Baba Farid** 2× 2006, 2010
- Wrong pairs: **Nizamuddin's tomb-Ajmer**, **Nizamuddin-Multan** 2× 2007, 2020
- **Mahbub-i-Ilahi**: **Nizamuddin Auliya**; he saw seven Sultans 2× 2014, 2014
- **Chirag-i-Delhi**: **Nasiruddin** 1× 2017
- **Shaikh-ul-Hind**: **Salim Chishti** 2× 2004, 2008
- **Muinuddin-Chishti, Sirhindi-Naqshbandi, Dara Shikoh-Qadiri, Shihabuddin-Suhrawardi** 1× 2013
- Against music: **Naqshbandiya** 3× 2002, 2003, 2013
- Counted Krishna among the auliyas: **Shah Muhammad Ghaus** (Shattari) 2× 2002, 2003
- Hath Yoga: practised by Nathpanthis and adopted by Sufis (both) 1× 2019

Silsila	In India	Note
Chishti	Muinuddin (Ajmer)	Music (sama), simple life
Suhrawardi	Bahauddin Zakariya (Multan)	Close to the state
Qadiri	Shah Niamatullah; Dara Shikoh	Baghdad origin
Naqshbandi	Baqi Billah; Ahmad Sirhindi	Orthodox; no music
Shattari	Shah Muhammad Ghaus	Yoga links

TRAP ALERT

- **Dvaita** (Madhva) vs **Dvaitadvaita** (Nimbarka); Advaita vs Shuddhadvaita.
- Assam Vaishnavism = **Shankaradeva**, not Chaitanya.
- Shaikh-ul-Hind = **Salim Chishti**; Sultan-ul-Hind = Muinuddin.
- Rasikpriya = **Keshavdas**; Raskhan = Premvatika.

UP LINK

UP link: **Ramananda** (born Prayag) and **Kabir** taught at **Varanasi**; **Tulsidas** wrote the Ramcharitmanas at Varanasi (born Rajapur, Chitrakoot); **Malukdas** was of **Kara**, and **Salim Chishti's** dargah is at **Fatehpur Sikri**.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Alvars started Bhakti; revival 15th-16th century
2. Ramanuja Vishishtadvaita; Madhva Dvaita; Vallabha Shuddhadvaita
3. Ramananda = Prayag; Kabir's guru
4. Namdev, Kabir, Nanak, Chaitanya, Mirabai
5. Shankaradeva = Assam; Chaitanya = Bengal
6. Malukdas = Kara; Raskhan = Premvatika
7. Muinuddin = Ajmer (Usman Haruni's disciple)
8. Nizamuddin = Delhi, Mahbub-i-Ilahi; Farid's disciple
9. Nasiruddin = Chirag-i-Delhi; Salim Chishti = Shaikh-ul-Hind
10. Naqshbandi opposed music; Sirhindi was Naqshbandi

Chapter 13

Mughal Dynasty: Babur

Built from 15 UPPSC questions (1990–2025). Focus: Chaghtai Turk origins, Kabul and the Padshah title, Daulat Khan's invitation, Panipat, Khanwa, Chanderi and Ghaghra, the Baburnama, the Babri mosque.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- ■ **First Panipat (1526)**: **Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi**; won by **skilled generalship**; first big use of **artillery** 5× 1990, 1996, 1996, 2012, 2016
- ■ **Khanwa (1527)**: Babur declared **jihad**, beat **Rana Sanga** 3× 2004, 2009, 2010
- • Babur wrote the **Baburnama** in **Turki**; the court language was **Persian** (A true, R false) 1× 2025

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

13.1 Rise of Babur

- Mughals were **Chaghtai Turks** 1× 2010
- Babur lost at **Sar-i-Pul** to **Shaibani Khan** 1× 2015
- Took the title **Padshah** at **Kabul** 1× 2015
- Invited to India by **Daulat Khan** Lodi 1× 2021

13.2 Battles

- ■ **First Panipat**: **Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi, 1526** 3× 1996, 2012, 2016
- Babur's victory: **skilled generalship** (key; many guides say artillery) 1× 1990
- First use of artillery among options: **First Panipat** (Bajaur 1519 was earlier) 1× 1996
- **Jihad** declared at **Khanwa** 1× 2009
- **Rana Sanga** fought Babur at **Khanwa** (1527) 2× 2004, 2010
- Wrong pair: **Chanderi-1530** (it was **1528**) 1× 2015

BABUR'S BATTLES

1526
Panipat: Ibrahim Lodi (tulughma, artillery)

↓

1527
Khanwa: Rana Sanga (jihad; title Ghazi)

↓

1528
Chanderi: Medini Rai

↓

1529
Ghaghra: Afghans under Mahmud Lodi and Nusrat Shah of Bengal

↓

1530
Dies at Agra; buried at Kabul

13.3 Baburnama and Babri Mosque

- Babur wrote in **Turki**, but the court language was **Persian** (A true, R false) 1× 2025
- Hindu state named in the Baburnama: **Mewar** (Vijayanagara also named) 1× 1995
- **Babri mosque** (Ayodhya) built by **Mir Baqi** 1× 1992

TRAP ALERT

- Mughals = **Chaghtai Turks**, not Mongols or Persians.
- Jihad was declared at **Khanwa**, not Panipat.
- Chanderi = **1528**; Ghaghra = **1529**.
- Babur died at Agra but lies at **Kabul**.

UP LINK

UP link: **Mir Baqi** built the mosque at **Ayodhya** (1528) in Babur's name; Babur died at **Agra** (1530), and the **Battle of Ghaghra** (1529) was fought in eastern UP.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Mughals = Chaghtai Turks
2. Shaibani Khan beat Babur at Sar-i-Pul
3. Padshah title at Kabul
4. Daulat Khan invited Babur
5. Panipat 1526: Ibrahim Lodi
6. Khanwa 1527: Rana Sanga; jihad
7. Chanderi 1528; Ghaghra 1529
8. Baburnama in Turki
9. Mewar named in the Baburnama
10. Mir Baqi built the Babri mosque

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Chapter 14

Humayun and Sher Shah

Built from 15 UPPSC questions (1993–2023). Focus: Humayun's family, Chausa and Kannauj, Sher Shah's rise, death at Kalinjar and tomb at Sasaram, the Purana Qila, revenue and the rupiya.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

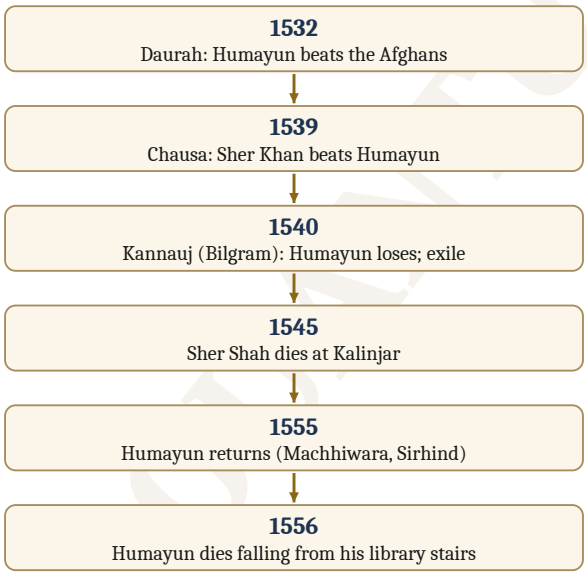
- **Sher Shah**: died at **Kalinjar** (1545), buried at **Sasaram** 4× 1993, 2002, 2015, 2016
- **Patta and qabuliyat**: **Sher Shah** 3× 2004, 2008, 2009
- **Kannauj (Bilgram), 17 May 1540**: **Sher Shah beat Humayun** 1× 2019
- **Purana Qila** in its present form and its **Qila-i-Kuhna** mosque: **Sher Shah** 3× 2009, 2016, 2021

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

14.1 Humayun

- Wrong pair: **Hamida Banu-wife of Alauddin** (she was Humayun's wife) 1× 2023
- Not Humayun's brother: **Usman** (brothers: Kamran, Askari, Hindal) 1× 2008
- Kannauj, 17 May 1540: **Sher Shah vs Humayun** 1× 2019
- Order: **Daurah, Chausa, Kannauj, Samugarh** 1× 2017

HUMAYUN AND THE AFGHANS



14.2 Sher Shah

- Highly educated ruler: **Sher Shah** (studied at Jaunpur) 1× 2010
- **Jaita and Kumpa** of **Marwar** impressed Sher Shah 1× 2022
- "Lost the empire for a handful of millet": **Sher Shah** 1× 2007
- Died at **Kalinjar**, his last campaign; buried at **Sasaram** 4× 1993, 2002, 2015, 2016
- **Purana Qila** in present form: **Sher Shah**; **Qila-i-Kuhna** mosque too 3× 2009, 2016, 2021
- Brilliant administrator (only 1) 1× 2021
- **Patta and qabuliyat**: **Sher Shah** 3× 2004, 2008, 2009
- Rupiya to dam: **1 : 64** (Sher Shah) 1× 2006

Sher Shah's reform	Detail
Land revenue	Measured land; one-third of produce
Patta, qabuliyat	Title deed and acceptance
Coinage	Silver rupiya, copper dam
Roads	Sarak-i-Azam (Grand Trunk Road), sarais
Dak	Horse post at sarais

TRAP ALERT

- Died at **Kalinjar** (UP); buried at **Sasaram** (Bihar).
- Chausa (1539) came **before** Kannauj (1540).
- Jaita and Kumpa were of **Marwar**, not Mewar.
- Rupiya:dam = 1:64 (Sher Shah) but 1:40 under Akbar.

UP LINK

UP link: **Chausa** lies on the UP-Bihar border near Buxar; **Kannauj (Bilgram)** in UP saw Humayun's final defeat (1540), and **Kalinjar fort** (Banda) is where Sher Shah died in 1545; he had studied at **Jaunpur**.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Hamida Banu = Humayun's wife (Akbar's mother)
2. Humayun's brothers: Kamran, Askari, Hindal
3. Daurah 1532; Chausa 1539; Kannauj 1540
4. Sher Shah educated at Jaunpur
5. Jaita and Kumpa = Marwar
6. Handful of millet = Sher Shah
7. Died at Kalinjar; buried at Sasaram
8. Purana Qila, Qila-i-Kuhna = Sher Shah
9. Patta, qabuliyat = Sher Shah
10. Rupiya:dam = 1:64

Chapter 15

Akbar

Built from 32 UPPSC questions (1990–2024). Focus: Bairam Khan, conquests, Rajput policy and Haldighati, religious policy, social reforms, mansabdari and revenue, court scholars and translations, Fatehpur Sikri.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Todar Mal**: **land revenue**; the link between Sher Shah and Akbar 3× 1992, 2007, 2012
- **Religious order**: **jizya abolished (1564), Ibadat Khana (1575), Mahzar (1579), Din-i-Ilahi (1582)** 2× 2003, 2006
- First Rajput marriage alliance: **Kachhwahas** of Amber; **Mewar** never submitted 3× 2004, 2004, 2016
- **Haldighati (1576)**: Pratap's commander **Hakim Sur** 3× 2016, 2016, one-liner
- **Badauni** translated the **Mahabharata** (Razmnama) and the Ramayana 4× 2013, 2015, 2016, 2016

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

15.1 Accession and Conquests

- Akbar gave Bairam Khan the title **Khan-i-Khanan** (only 1) 1× 2024
- Killed personally by Akbar: **Adham Khan** 1× 2010
- Order: **Malwa invasion, Amber marriage, Karrani conquest of Orissa, Tukaroi** 1× 2021
- First Rajput marriage: **Kachhwahas** (Amber) 2× 2004, 2016
- Did not accept Akbar willingly: **Mewar** 1× 2004
- Pratap's other commander at Haldighati: **Hakim Sur** 2× 2016, 2016
- **Haldighati**: **1576** 1× one-liner

15.2 Religion and Society

- Akbar visited **Muinuddin Chishti's** dargah 1× 2012
- Order: **jizya abolished, Ibadat Khana, Mahzar, Din-i-Ilahi** 2× 2003, 2006
- A fatwa against Akbar came from **Jaunpur** 1× 2011
- **Sulh-i-kul**: result of **all the above** influences 1× 1998
- Historian calling Din-i-Ilahi a religion: **none** of them 1× 2000
- Jain scholar honoured by Akbar: **Hiravijaya Suri** 2× 2002, 2012
- Akbar's popularity: **mansabdari, religious policy, revenue, social reform** (all) 1× 1990
- One wife unless the first was barren: **Akbar** 1× 2002
- Akbar tried to fix marriage age and let girls choose (both) 1× 2020

AKBAR'S RELIGIOUS PATH



15.3 Administration and Culture

- Military system: **mansabdari** 1× 1992
- First proper diwan: **Muzaffar Khan Turbati** 2× 2002, 2003
- **Todar Mal**: **land revenue** (dahsala); link between Sher Shah and Akbar 3× 1992, 2007, 2012
- Order: **Sheikh Mubarak's death, Faizi's death, Abul Fazl's murder, Daniyal's death** 1× 2024
- **Mahabharata** into Persian (**Razmnama**): **Badauni** 3× 2015, 2016, 2016
- **Ramayana** into Persian: **Badauni** 1× 2013
- "**Zarrin Qalam**": **Muhammad Husain** (calligrapher) 1× 1995
- Buland Darwaza was built for the **Gujarat** victory, not Jahangir's birth (A true, R false) 1× 1998
- Akbar built the **Buland Darwaza** and **Panch Mahal** 2× 1993, 2004
- Not Akbar's fort: **Red Fort, Delhi** (Shah Jahan) 1× 2015
- Contemporary of Elizabeth I: **Akbar**; an "**enlightened despot**" 2× 2002, 2009

Akbar's reform	Detail
Mansabdari	Zat and sawar ranks (from 1573-77)
Dahsala (Zabti)	Todar Mal; 10-year average (1580)
Ain-i-Dahsala	Revenue on average produce and prices
Translation bureau	Maktab Khana; Razmnama, Ramayana
Fatehpur Sikri	Buland Darwaza, Panch Mahal, Diwan-i-Khas

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

TRAP ALERT

- Jizya was abolished in **1564**, eleven years **before** the Ibadat Khana.
- First diwan = **Muzaffar Khan Turbati**, not Todar Mal.
- Zarrin Qalam = Muhammad Husain; Shirin Qalam = Abdus Samad.
- Buland Darwaza celebrates **Gujarat** (1573), not Salim's birth.

UP LINK

UP link: **Fatehpur Sikri** (Agra) has the Buland Darwaza, Panch Mahal, Ibadat Khana and Salim Chishti's tomb; Akbar's tomb is at **Sikandra**, and the **Agra fort** and **Allahabad fort** are his; a fatwa against him came from **Jaunpur**.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Bairam Khan = Khan-i-Khanan; Adham Khan killed by Akbar
2. Kachhwahas first Rajput alliance; Mewar resisted
3. Haldighati 1576; Hakim Sur
4. Jizya 1564; Ibadat Khana 1575; Mahzar 1579; Din-i-Ilahi 1582
5. Hiravijaya Suri = Jain scholar at court
6. Mansabdari; Muzaffar Khan Turbati first diwan
7. Todar Mal = land revenue (dahsala)
8. Badauni = Razmnama, Ramayana in Persian
9. Buland Darwaza = Gujarat victory; Panch Mahal
10. Akbar = Elizabeth I's contemporary

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Chapter 16

Jahangir

Built from 14 UPPSC questions (1991–2023). Focus: the revolts of the reign, Nur Jahan's junta, the Mewar treaty, Hawkins and Thomas Roe, Pelsaert, the Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri, Mughal tombs.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Thomas Roe** (envoy of James I) met Jahangir at **Ajmer**; **Hawkins** came first ("English Khan") 6× 1993, 2007, 2008, 2013, 2015, 2023
- **Treaty with Mewar (1615)** with Amar Singh: under **Jahangir** 2× 2008, 2008
- **Pelsaert** (Dutch) wrote on Jahangir's reign 2× 2010, 2017
- Jahangir wrote his autobiography (**Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri**) in **Persian** 2× 2001, 2010

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

16.1 Revolts and Nur Jahan

- Rewarded the killer of Abul Fazl (Bir Singh Bundela): **Jahangir** 1× 2003
- Rebels against Jahangir: **Khurram, Mahabat Khan, Khusrau** (2, 3, 4) 1× 2013
- Not in Nur Jahan's junta: **Jahangir** (junta: Itimad-ud-Daula, Asaf Khan, Khurram) 1× 2015
- Treaty with Mewar: **Jahangir** (1615) 2× 2008, 2008

16.2 Europeans at Court

- First EIC man at Jahangir's court: **Hawkins** 1× 1993
- "**English Khan**": **William Hawkins** 1× 2015
- Hawkins knew **Turkish** well; he came in 1608, not 1611 (only 2) 1× 2023
- **Thomas Roe** came under **Jahangir**, sent by **James I** 2× 2008, 2013
- Roe met Jahangir at **Ajmer** 1× 2007
- Dutch account of Jahangir's reign: **Francisco Pelsaert** 2× 2010, 2017

Visitor	Ruler	Note
William Hawkins	Jahangir (1608)	English Khan; first EIC envoy
Thomas Roe	Jahangir (1615-19)	James I's envoy; Surat factory rights
Francisco Pelsaert	Jahangir	Dutch; Remonstrantie
Peter Mundy, Manucci	Shah Jahan	Travel accounts
Bernier, Tavernier	Shah Jahan, Aurangzeb	French

16.3 Memoirs and Tombs

- Autobiography in Persian: **Jahangir** (Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri) 2× 2001, 2010
- No mausoleum in India: **Babur** (Kabul) and **Jahangir** (Shahdara, Lahore) 2× 1991, 2016

TRAP ALERT

- Hawkins = **first**; Roe = official royal envoy (James I).
- Roe's audience was at **Ajmer**, not Agra.
- "Baby Taj" = Itimad-ud-Daula (Agra); "Second Taj" = Bibi ka Maqbara.
- Asaf Khan never rebelled; Mahabat Khan did (1626).

UP LINK

UP link: Nur Jahan built the tomb of her father **Itimad-ud-Daula** ("Baby Taj") at **Agra**; Jahangir completed **Akbar's tomb at Sikandra** and set up his "chain of justice" at the **Agra fort**.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Bir Singh Bundela killed Abul Fazl; Jahangir rewarded him
2. Khurram, Mahabat Khan, Khusrau rebelled
3. Nur Jahan's junta: Itimad-ud-Daula, Asaf Khan, Khurram
4. Mewar treaty 1615 (Amar Singh)
5. Hawkins first; English Khan
6. Thomas Roe at Ajmer; James I's envoy
7. Pelsaert = Dutch account
8. Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri in Persian
9. Jahangir buried at Shahdara (Lahore)
10. Itimad-ud-Daula = Baby Taj (Agra)

Chapter 17

Shah Jahan

Built from 15 UPPSC questions (1992–2022). Focus: the move to Delhi and the end of sijda, the Red Fort and Jama Masjid, the Kohinoor, court poets and Sanskrit scholars, Dara Shikoh's Sirr-i-Akbar.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- ■ **Upanishads** into Persian (**Sirr-i-Akbar**) by **Dara Shikoh** under **Shah Jahan** 6× 1992, 2000, 2002, 2004, 2006, 2009
- ■ **Shah Jahan** moved the capital to **Delhi**, built the **Red Fort** and **Jama Masjid** 4× 2002, 2004, 2008, 2010
- • Abolished **sijda**: **Shah Jahan** (Balban began it) 2× 2010, 2010

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

17.1 Court and Buildings

- Capital moved from Agra to **Delhi**: **Shah Jahan** 1× 2008
- Abolished **sijda**: **Shah Jahan** 2× 2010, 2010
- **Lal Qila** (Delhi): **Shah Jahan** 2× 2002, 2010
- **Jama Masjid**, Delhi: **Shah Jahan** 1× 2004
- **Kohinoor** given by **Mir Jumla** 1× 2015
- Poet laureate: **Kalim** 1× 2015
- Patronised **Kavindracharya Saraswati** of Banaras: **Shah Jahan** 1× 2022
- Led Banaras pandits to end the pilgrim tax: **Kavindracharya** 1× 2000
- Deccan governor for most of the reign: **Aurangzeb** 1× 2009

17.2 Dara Shikoh

- ■ Upanishads into Persian under **Shah Jahan** 3× 1992, 2006, 2009
- ■ Title: **Sirr-i-Akbar**, by **Dara Shikoh** 3× 2000, 2002, 2004
- "**Shah Buland Iqbal**": **Dara Shikoh** 1× 2014
- First Muslim to study Hindu scriptures (key): **Dara Shikoh** 1× 2003
- Dara is buried in **Delhi** (Humayun's tomb) 1× 2017

Shah Jahan's buildings	Place
Taj Mahal	Agra
Moti Masjid (Agra fort), marble palaces	Agra
Red Fort, Jama Masjid, Shahjahanabad	Delhi
Peacock Throne	Delhi court

TRAP ALERT

- Sijda began under **Balban**, ended under **Shah Jahan**.
- Agra fort = Akbar; Delhi Red Fort = Shah Jahan.
- Moti Masjid: Agra = Shah Jahan; Delhi Red Fort = **Aurangzeb**.
- Sirr-i-Akbar (Dara) has nothing to do with Emperor Akbar.

UP LINK

UP link: the **Taj Mahal** at **Agra** is Shah Jahan's tomb for Mumtaz Mahal; **Kavindracharya** of **Banaras** won relief from the pilgrim tax on Banaras and Allahabad, and Shah Jahan spent his last years captive in the **Agra fort**.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Capital to Delhi; Red Fort, Jama Masjid
2. Abolished sijda
3. Mir Jumla gave the Kohinoor
4. Kalim = poet laureate
5. Kavindracharya of Banaras
6. Aurangzeb = Deccan governor
7. Dara = Sirr-i-Akbar (Upanishads)
8. Dara = Shah Buland Iqbal
9. Dara buried in Delhi
10. Taj Mahal = Agra

Chapter 18

Aurangzeb

Built from 17 UPPSC questions (1992–2022). Focus: the war of succession, two coronations, Zinda Pir and jizya, Prince Akbar's revolt, Purandar, Bijapur and Golconda, family and buildings.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

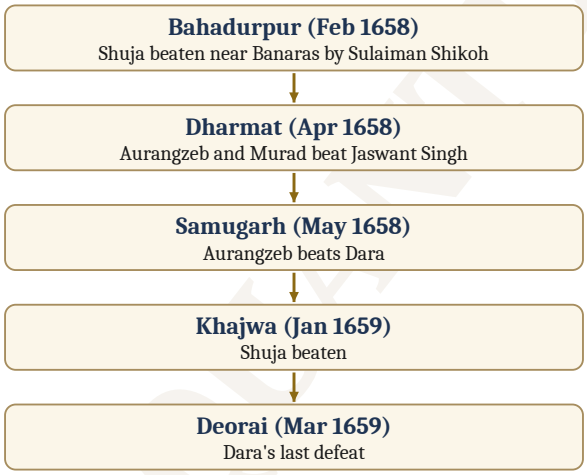
- ■ **Treaty of Purandar (1665)**: Shivaji with **Jai Singh** 5× 2008, 2009, 2010, 2010, 2011
- ■ Aurangzeb conquered **Bijapur (1686)** and **Golconda (1687, Abul Hasan Qutb Shah)** 4× 1992, 2004, 2004, 2020
- ■ Aurangzeb had the **most Hindu generals**; re-imposed **jizya**; called "**Zinda Pir**" 5× 1998, 2000, 2002, 2004, 2017
- • **Crowned twice**: **Aurangzeb** 2× 2006, 2009

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

18.1 Succession

- Aurangzeb succeeded, but **not** by primogeniture (A true, R false) 1× 1994
- Crowned twice: **Aurangzeb** (1658, 1659) 2× 2006, 2009
- Order: **Shuja's defeat near Banaras, Dharmat, Samugarh, Deorai** 1× 2022
- Order: **Bilgram (1540), Sarnal (1573), Dharmat (1658), Jajau (1707)** 1× 2019

WAR OF SUCCESSION (1657-59)



18.2 Policy and Revolts

- "**Zinda Pir**": **Aurangzeb** 1× 2017
- Re-imposed **jizya**: **Aurangzeb** (1679) 1× 2002
- ■ Most Hindu generals: **Aurangzeb** 3× 1998, 2000, 2004
- Son who revolted: **Prince Akbar** (1681) 1× 2007
- ■ **Purandar**: Shivaji and **Jai Singh** 5× 2008, 2009, 2010, 2010, 2011
- Deccan conquests: **Bijapur and Golconda** 2× 2004, 2004
- Bijapur won in **1686** 1× 1992
- Golconda ruler in 1687: **Abul Hasan Qutb Shah** 1× 2020
- **Samarth Ramdas**: **Aurangzeb's** time 1× 2009

18.3 Family and Buildings

- Aurangzeb's daughter: **Mehrunnisa** 1× 2005
- "**Sahibat-uz-Zamani**": **Jahanara** 1× 2014
- "Second Taj": tomb of **Rabia-ud-Daurani** (Bibi ka Maqbara) 2× 2000, 2013
- **Moti Masjid**, Red Fort: **Aurangzeb** 2× 2001, 2002

TRAP ALERT

- Purandar = **Jai Singh**; Afzal Khan and Shaista Khan are other episodes.
- Bijapur 1686 = Sikandar Adil Shah; Golconda 1687 = Abul Hasan.
- Shuja's defeat near Banaras was by **Sulaiman Shikoh**, not Aurangzeb.
- Aurangzeb is buried at **Khuldabad**.

UP LINK

UP link: **Shuja** was defeated near **Banaras** (Bahadurpur, 1658) and at **Khajwa** (Fatehpur, 1659); Aurangzeb built the **Gyanvapi mosque** at Varanasi and mosques at **Mathura**, and Shivaji escaped from **Agra** in 1666.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Succession not by primogeniture
2. Crowned twice: 1658 and 1659
3. Dharmat, Samugarh, Deorai
4. Zinda Pir; jizya re-imposed 1679
5. Most Hindu nobles under Aurangzeb
6. Prince Akbar revolted (1681)
7. Purandar 1665 = Jai Singh
8. Bijapur 1686; Golconda 1687 (Abul Hasan)
9. Jahanara = Sahibat-uz-Zamani
10. Bibi ka Maqbara = Second Taj; Moti Masjid (Delhi)

Chapter 19

Mughal Administration

Built from 20 UPPSC questions (1992–2021). Focus: the central officers, subah-sarkar-pargana, mansabdari, land revenue terms, coins, Europeans in Mughal service and canals.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- ■ **Mansabdari**: started by **Akbar**; **zat and sawar** ranks; **not hereditary**; sawar could **not** exceed zat 4× 2009, 2010, 2010, 2019
- • **Mir Bakhshi** = head of the **army** (pay and recruitment) 2× 1992, 2004
- • **Land revenue** = main income; **mal** = land revenue 2× 1995, 2009
- ■ **Coins**: Babur's silver **shahrukhi**; copper **dam**; Akbar's **Ram-Siya** coins 3× 2008, 2011, 2017

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

19.1 Officers and Units

- The Mughal state was first a **military state** (A and R true, R explains A) 1× 2021
- Army head: **Mir Bakhshi**; also oversaw officials 2× 1992, 2004
- Wazirs: **Akbar-Muzaffar Khan, Jahangir-Itimad-ud-Daula, Shah Jahan-Sadullah Khan, Aurangzeb-Asad Khan** 1× 2021
- **Diwan-i-Tan**: jagirs and salaries (with other officers' duties) 1× 2020
- District: **sarkar** 1× 2009
- **Chakla**: unit **between subah and pargana**, not the same as a sarkar 1× 2018

MUGHAL ADMINISTRATIVE UNITS

Subah
Province (subahdar, diwan)
↓
Sarkar
District (faujdar, amalguzar)
↓
Pargana
Group of villages (shiqdar, amil, qanungo)
↓
Gram
Village (muqaddam, patwari)

19.2 Mansabdari and Revenue

- Mansabdars were the official nobility started by **Akbar**; **not hereditary** (only 1) 1× 2019
- Not true: **sawar rank could exceed zat** 1× 2009
- Zat and mansab granted; **three classes** (1 and 3) 2× 2010, 2010
- Main income: **land revenue** 1× 1995
- **Mal**: **land revenue** 1× 2009
- Akbar's Deccan revenue: by the **number of ploughs** 1× 2017

Land class	Fallow period
Polaj	Cultivated every year
Parauti	Fallow 1-2 years
Chachar	Fallow 3-4 years
Banjar	Fallow 5 years or more

19.3 Coins, Europeans and Canals

- Silver **shahrukhi**: **Babur** 1× 2017
- Akbar regulated currency like Sher Shah; dam continued (A and R true, R explains A, per source) 1× 2019
- Copper coin: **dam** 1× 2008
- **Ram-Siya** coins: **Akbar** 1× 2011
- Physician in Mughal service: **Manucci** 1× 2008
- Banned tobacco: **Jahangir** 1× 2005
- Canal restoring Firuz's Rajabwah: **Shahab Nahar** 1× 2020

TRAP ALERT

- District = **sarkar**, not subah.
- Mansabs were **not** hereditary; sawar never exceeded zat.
- Mir Bakhshi = military paymaster; Diwan-i-Tan = jagirs and salaries.
- Rupiya:dam = 1:40 under Akbar (1:64 under Sher Shah).

UP LINK

UP link: the **subahs** of **Agra, Allahabad (Ilahabad)** and **Awadh** covered most of present UP; Akbar created the Allahabad subah and built its fort at the Sangam.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Mughal state = military state at first
2. Mir Bakhshi = army head
3. Subah, sarkar, pargana, village
4. Chakla = between subah and pargana
5. Mansabdari: Akbar; zat and sawar; not hereditary
6. Land revenue = main income; mal = revenue
7. Polaj, parauti, chachar, banjar
8. Shahrukhi = Babur; dam = copper; Ram-Siya = Akbar
9. Manucci = physician; Jahangir banned tobacco
10. Shahab Nahar restored Firuz's canal

Chapter 20

Music and Painting in the Mughal Period

Built from 15 UPPSC questions (1991–2021). Focus: Humayun and Akbar's painters, Jahangir's golden age, Abul Hasan and Mansur, regional schools, Swami Haridas, Tansen and Dhrupad, the emperors and music.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

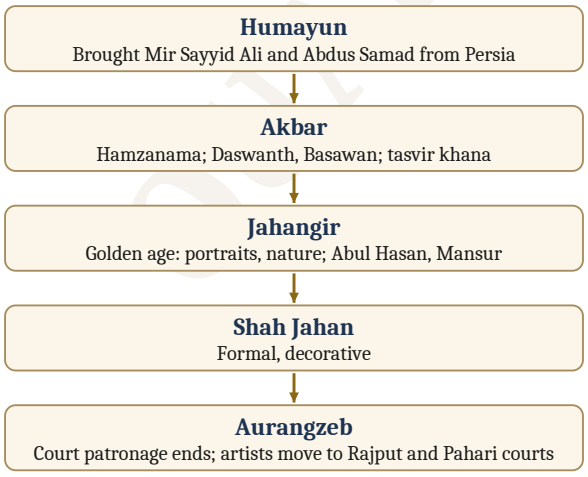
- **Mughal painting** founded by **Humayun** (Mir Sayyid Ali, Abdus Samad) 3× 2009, 2010, 2012
- **Jahangir** patronised **painting**: **Abul Hasan** (Nadir-uz-Zaman), **Mansur** (Nadir-ul-Asr, birds) 5× 1998, 2012, 2013, 2014, 2016
- **Tansen**: pupil of **Swami Haridas**; tomb at **Gwalior**; earlier patron Raja **Ramchandra of Rewa** 4× 1999, 2009, 2010, 2019

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

20.1 Painting

- Foundation of Mughal painting: **Humayun** 3× 2009, 2010, 2012
- Statements on Mughal painting: **all** true 1× 1991
- Jahangir mainly patronised **painting** 1× 2016
- Jahangir's painters: **Abul Hasan and Aqa Riza** (2 and 3) 1× 2012
- "**Nadir-uz-Zaman**": **Abul Hasan** 1× 2013
- "**Nadir-ul-Asr**" and greatest bird painter: **Mansur** 2× 1998, 2014
- Pahari, Rajput, Mughal, Kangra: styles of **painting** 1× 1994

GROWTH OF MUGHAL PAINTING



20.2 Music

- Haridas' followers set up **5** music centres (per key) 1× 2009
- Akbar's Dhrupad singers: **Tansen and Haridas** (1 and 2) 1× 2010
- **Tansen's tomb**: **Gwalior** 1× 1999
- Tansen's patron before Akbar: **Raja Ramchandra** (Baghela) 1× 2019
- Not a great name in Hindustani music: **Mal Gurjari** (a raga) 1× 2021
- Learnt Hindu music from Lala Kalawant: **Akbar** 1× 2016
- Aurangzeb played the **veena** 2× 2007, 2010

TRAP ALERT

- Nadir-uz-Zaman = **Abul Hasan**; Nadir-ul-Asr = **Mansur**.
- Mughal painting began under **Humayun**, not Akbar.
- Tansen's tomb is at **Gwalior**; he sang at Fatehpur Sikri.
- Aurangzeb ended court music but could play the veena.

UP LINK

UP link: **Swami Haridas** lived at **Vrindavan** (Mathura), where Tansen is said to have learnt from him; **Fatehpur Sikri** had Akbar's painting workshops and Tansen's performances.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Humayun founded Mughal painting
2. Mir Sayyid Ali and Abdus Samad = Persian masters
3. Jahangir = golden age of painting
4. Abul Hasan = Nadir-uz-Zaman
5. Mansur = Nadir-ul-Asr, birds
6. Kangra and Basohli = Pahari schools
7. Haridas = Tansen's guru (Vrindavan)
8. Tansen buried at Gwalior; patron Ramchandra of Rewa
9. Akbar learnt from Lala Kalawant
10. Aurangzeb played the veena

Chapter 21

Mughal Literature

Built from 20 UPPSC questions (1994–2023). Focus: the Baburnama, Gulbadan Begum and Maham Anaga, Persian at court and the Akbarnama, chronicler-book matching, Persian translations, Hindi Bhakti poets and Sufi premakhyans.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Gulbadan Begum** (Babur's daughter) wrote the **Humayun-nama** 6× 1994, 1998, 2002, 2004, 2004, 2004
- **Ain-i-Akbari** = third volume of the **Akbarnama**; court language = **Persian** 3× 2012, 2014, 2023
- **Chronicler matching**: **Hasan Nizami-Taj-ul-Maasir, Khwandamir-Humayun-nama, Muhammad Kazim-Alamgirnama, Bhimsen-Nuskha-i-Dilkusha, Sujan Rai-Khulasat-ut-Tawarikh, Chandrabhan-Chahar Chaman** 2× 2003, 2017
- **Maham Anaga** built the **Madrasa-i-Begum** and **Khair-ul-Manazil** mosque 2× 2012, 2018

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

21.1 Memoirs and Women Writers

- Baburnama into English: **Leyden and Erskine** 1× 2017
- Correct pair: **Babur-Tuzuk-i-Baburi** 1× 2009
- **Gulbadan Begum**: daughter of **Babur**; wrote the **Humayun-nama** 6× 1994, 1998, 2002, 2004, 2004, 2004
- **Madrasa-i-Begum** and **Khair-ul-Manazil** (opposite Purana Qila): **Maham Anaga** 2× 2012, 2018

21.2 Persian Histories and Translations

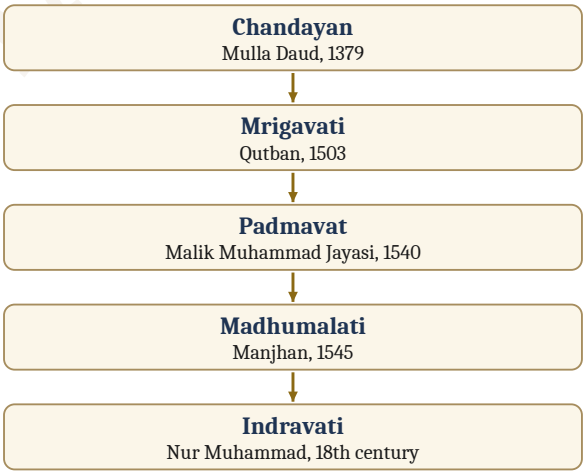
- Court language: **Persian** 1× 2012
- Akbarnama finished in **seven years** (per key) 1× 2014
- Third volume of the Akbarnama: **Ain-i-Akbari** 1× 2023
- Wrong pair: **Tughlaqnama-Ibn Battuta** (it is **Amir Khusrau's**) 1× 2019
- **Hasan Nizami-Taj-ul-Maasir, Khwandamir-Humayun-nama, Muhammad Kazim-Alamgirnama, Bhimsen-Nuskha-i-Dilkusha** 1× 2003
- **Bhimsen-Nuskha-i-Dilkusha, Chandrabhan-Chahar Chaman, Ishwardas Nagar-Futuhat-i-Alamgiri, Sujan Rai Bhandari-Khulasat-ut-Tawarikh** 1× 2017
- **Hitopadesha** into Persian: **Taj-ul-Mali** 1× 2013
- **Anwar-i-Suhaili**: translation of the **Panchatantra** 1× 1999

Persian work	Author	Subject
Akbarnama, Ain-i-Akbari	Abul Fazl	Akbar
Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh	Badauni	Akbar (critical)
Tabaqat-i-Akbari	Nizamuddin Ahmad	Akbar
Padshahnama	Abdul Hamid Lahori	Shah Jahan
Alamgirnama	Muhammad Kazim	Aurangzeb
Muntakhab-ul-Lubab	Khafi Khan	Later Mughals

21.3 Hindi Poets and Premakhyans

- **Ramchandrika** and **Rasikpriya**: **Keshavdas** 1× 2008
- Krishna verses as "**Nagari Das**": **Raja Sawant Singh** (Kishangarh) 2× 2004, 2010
- **Ras Panchadhyayi-Nand Das, Chaitanya Bhagavata-Vrindavan Das, Chaitanya Mangal-Jayananda, Bhakti Ratnakar-Narahari Chakravarti** 1× 2021
- Wrong pair: **Gangabai-Ganesh Dev Leela** 1× 2023
- Written first: **Mrigavati** (Qutban, 1503) 1× 2014

SUFI PREMAKHYANS IN HINDI



TRAP ALERT

- Only **Babur** and **Jahangir** wrote their own memoirs.
- Two Humayun-namas: **Gulbadan** (memoir), **Khwandamir** (Qanun-i-Humayuni).
- Tughlaqnama = **Amir Khusrau**, not Ibn Battuta (Rihla).
- Mrigavati is older than Padmavat.

UP LINK

UP link: **Malik Muhammad Jayasi** wrote the **Padmavat** (1540) at **Jais** (Amethi); **Qutban's Mrigavati** came from the Jaunpur region, and **Tulsidas** and **Surdas** wrote in Awadhi and Braj in UP.

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Leyden and Erskine = Baburnama in English
2. Gulbadan Begum = Humayun-nama
3. Maham Anaga = Madrasa-i-Begum, Khair-ul-Manazil
4. Persian = court language
5. Ain-i-Akbari = third volume of the Akbarnama
6. Kazim = Alamgirnama; Bhimsen = Nuskha-i-Dilkusha
7. Sujan Rai = Khulasat-ut-Tawarikh
8. Anwar-i-Suhaili = Panchatantra
9. Keshavdas = Rasikpriya, Ramchandrika
10. Mrigavati before Padmavat

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Chapter 22

Mughal Period: Miscellaneous

Built from 26 UPPSC questions (1992–2025). Focus: English travellers, the order of rulers and battles, revolts against Aurangzeb, women rulers, burial places, monuments and their builders, court terms.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Traveller-date matching**: **Ralph Fitch 1585-86, Hawkins 1608-11, Roe 1615-19, Manucci 1653-1708** 2× 2016, 2021
- **Burial places**: **Babur-Kabul, Humayun-Delhi, Akbar-Sikandra, Jahangir-Lahore, Shah Jahan-Agra, Aurangzeb-Khuldabad** 4× 1992, 2005, 2010, one-liner
- **Monument-builder**: **Babur-Sambhal Jama Masjid, Humayun-Dinpanah, Akbar-Jahangiri Mahal, Jahangir-Itimad-ud-Daula; Alai Darwaza-Alauddin, Buland Darwaza-Akbar, Moti Masjid Agra-Shah Jahan, Moti Masjid Delhi-Aurangzeb** 5× 2006, 2010, 2010, 2010, 2011
- **Battle order**: **Khanwa, Chanderi, Daurah, Chausa, Kannauj, Talikota, Samugarh** 3× 2016, 2016, 2025

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

22.1 Travellers and Rulers

- **Hawkins-1608-11, Roe-1615-19, Manucci-1653-1708, Ralph Fitch-1585-86** 1× 2016
- Order: **Ralph Fitch, Hawkins, Downton, Roe** 1× 2021
- Order: **Jahangir, Muhammad Shah, Ahmad Shah Abdali, Bahadur Shah II** 3× 2001, 2002, 2003
- True: **Abdali fought Third Panipat; Jahangir loved nature** (1 and 4) 1× 2010
- **Third Panipat-1761, Second Tarain-1192, Akbar's death-1605, Aurangzeb's death-1707** 1× 2005

22.2 Battles and Revolts

- **Haldighati-Akbar, Bilgram-Humayun, Khusrau's revolt-Jahangir, Khanwa-Babur** 1× 2012
- Wrong pair: **Jahangir-Battle of Balkh** (Balkh = Shah Jahan) 1× 2010
- Battles order (1998 item): Tarain, Haldighati, Asirgarh (1601), Third Panipat 1× 1998
- Order: **Daurah, Chausa, Kannauj, Samugarh** 1× 2025
- Order: **Chanderi, Chausa, Kannauj, Talikota** 1× 2016
- Order: **Khanwa, Chausa, Kannauj, Talikota** 1× 2016
- **Jat-1669, Satnami-1672, Sikh-1675**; Bundela dated 1554 per key (*) 1× 2023
- Women rulers in order: **Padmini, Durgavati, Tarabai, Ahilyabai** 2× 2001, 2002

22.3 Tombs and Monuments

- **Babur-Kabul, Humayun-Delhi, Jahangir-Lahore, Shah Jahan-Agra** 1× one-liner
- **Babur-Kabul, Akbar-Sikandra, Jahangir-Lahore, Shah Jahan-Agra** 1× 2005
- **Akbar's tomb**: **Sikandra** (Agra) 1× 1992
- Correct: **Delhi-tomb of Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan** 1× 2010
- **Babur-Sambhal Jama Masjid, Humayun-Dinpanah, Akbar-Jahangiri Mahal, Jahangir-Itimad-ud-Daula's tomb** 2× 2010, 2011
- **Alai Darwaza-Alauddin, Buland Darwaza-Akbar, Moti Masjid (Agra)-Shah Jahan, Moti Masjid (Delhi)-Aurangzeb** 2× 2006, 2010
- Order: **Atala Mosque, Sher Shah's tomb, Humayun's tomb, Rabia Daurani's tomb** 1× 2019
- **Govind Palace** (Hindu architecture): **Datia** 1× 2005

Emperor	Tomb
Babur	Kabul
Humayun	Delhi
Akbar	Sikandra (Agra)
Jahangir	Shahdara (Lahore)
Shah Jahan	Taj Mahal (Agra)
Aurangzeb	Khuldabad (Maharashtra)

22.4 Festivals, Learning and Terms

- **Nauroz** adopted from the **Zoroastrians** (Persians) 1× 2001
- Madrasa for Muslim jurisprudence: **Lucknow** (Firangi Mahal) 1× 2016
- Wrong pair: **jarib-a type of tax** (it is a measuring chain) 1× 2019
- **Muallim**: a ship's **navigator**; no option exact (*) 1× 2014

TRAP ALERT

- Jahangiri Mahal (Agra fort) was built by **Akbar**; Itimad-ud-Daula's tomb by **Nur Jahan**.
- Kannauj and Bilgram are the **same** battle (1540).
- Talikota (1565) had no Mughal side but often ends order questions.
- Jarib = measuring chain; muallim = navigator.

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

UP LINK

UP link: Babur's **Jama Masjid at Sambhal**, Akbar's **Sikandra** tomb, the **Taj Mahal** and **Itimad-ud-Daula** (Agra) are in UP, and **Firangi Mahal, Lucknow** was the great school of Islamic jurisprudence.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Fitch 1585; Hawkins 1608; Roe 1615; Manucci 1653
2. Jahangir, Muhammad Shah, Abdali, Bahadur Shah II
3. Third Panipat 1761; Akbar died 1605; Aurangzeb 1707
4. Jat 1669; Satnami 1672; Sikh 1675
5. Padmini, Durgavati, Tarabai, Ahilyabai
6. Babur Kabul; Humayun Delhi; Akbar Sikandra; Jahangir Lahore
7. Sambhal Jama Masjid = Babur; Dinpanah = Humayun
8. Moti Masjid Agra = Shah Jahan; Delhi = Aurangzeb
9. Nauroz from Zoroastrians; Firangi Mahal = Lucknow
10. Jarib = measuring chain

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Chapter 23

Sikh Sect

Built from 10 UPPSC questions (1996–2021). Focus: Guru Nanak, succession and the ten Gurus, Gurmukhi and Amritsar, the executions of Arjan Dev and Tegh Bahadur, Gobind Singh and the Khalsa, Banda Bahadur.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- Gurus executed by the Mughals: **Arjan Dev** (Jahangir) and **Tegh Bahadur** (Aurangzeb) 2× 2001, 2002
- **Guru Gobind Singh** founded the **Khalsa** (1699); his samadhi is at **Nanded** 2× 2002, 2006
- **Guru Nanak**: born at **Nankana**; founded Sikhism under **Sikandar Lodi**; successor **Lehna (Angad)** 3× 2007, 2008, 2021

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

23.1 The Gurus

- Guru Nanak's birthplace: **Nankana** (Talwandi) 1× 2007
- Founded Sikhism under **Sikandar Lodi** 1× 2008
- Nanak's successor: **Lehna** (Guru Angad) 1× 2021
- **Gurmukhi** started by **Guru Angad** 1× 2017
- **Amritsar** founded by **Guru Ram Das** 1× 1996
- Put to death: **Arjan Dev and Tegh Bahadur** (2 and 4) 1× 2002
- Helped rebel prince **Khusrau**: **Guru Arjan Dev** 1× 2001
- **Khalsa** founded by **Guru Gobind Singh** 1× 2006
- **Nanded**: samadhi of **Guru Gobind Singh** 1× 2002
- Banda Bahadur's original name: **Lachhman Dev** 1× 2014

Guru	Known for
Nanak	Founder; Kartarpur
Angad	Gurmukhi script
Amar Das	Langar, manjis
Ram Das	Founded Amritsar
Arjan Dev	Adi Granth (1604); executed under Jahangir
Hargobind	Akal Takht; militarised the Sikhs
Tegh Bahadur	Executed under Aurangzeb (1675)
Gobind Singh	Khalsa (1699); died at Nanded

TRAP ALERT

- Amritsar = **Ram Das**; Harmandir and Adi Granth = **Arjan Dev**.
- Hargobind was imprisoned at Gwalior but **not** executed.
- Gobind Singh: born at **Patna**, Khalsa at **Anandpur**, died at **Nanded**.

UP LINK

UP link: Guru Nanak visited **Varanasi, Ayodhya** and **Prayag**; Guru Tegh Bahadur stayed at **Prayagraj** (Pakki Sangat) and Agra, where he was arrested before his execution in Delhi (1675).

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Nanak born at Nankana
2. Sikhism under Sikandar Lodi
3. Lehna = Guru Angad; Gurmukhi
4. Amritsar = Ram Das
5. Arjan Dev executed (Jahangir); helped Khusrau
6. Tegh Bahadur executed (Aurangzeb, 1675)
7. Gobind Singh = Khalsa 1699
8. Nanded = Gobind Singh's samadhi
9. Banda Bahadur = Lachhman Dev
10. Hargobind = Akal Takht

Chapter 24

Maratha State and Confederacy

Built from 25 UPPSC questions (1990–2025). Focus: why the Marathas rose, Shivaji's campaigns and coronation, Ashtapradhan, chauth and coins, the successors and Tarabai, the Peshwas, Third Panipat.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Ashtapradhan** = Shivaji's council of eight ministers 4× 1991, 1995, 1997, 2013
- **Third Panipat (1761)**: Marathas beaten by the **Afghans** under **Ahmad Shah Abdali**; Najib Khan Rohilla his ally 5× 1993, 1994, 2004, 2006, 2012
- **Peshwa order**: **Balaji Vishwanath, Baji Rao I, Balaji Baji Rao, Madhav Rao I, Narayan Rao, Raghunath Rao** 4× 2004, 2023, 2024, 2025
- Shivaji's capital: **Raigarh**, crowned there in **1674** 3× 1990, 2015, 2016
- **Tarabai** led the Marathas at Aurangzeb's death 3× 2008, 2012, 2013

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

24.1 Shivaji

- Reasons for the Maratha rise: **all of the above** 1× 1992
- Big Deshmukhs opposed Shivaji as they wished to stay Bijapur's vassals (A and R true, R explains A) 1× 2024
- Born **1627** (key; 1630 is also used), crowned **1674** 1× 2015
- Bijapur sent **Afzal Khan** (1659) 1× 1999
- Order: **Chakan, Afzal Khan, clash with the Mughals, sack of Surat** 1× 2016
- Shivaji beat the Mughals at **Salher** 1× 2005
- Capital and coronation: **Raigarh** 2× 1990, 2016

24.2 Administration

- **Ashtapradhan**: **Maratha** council 3× 1991, 1995, 2013
- **Sar-i-Naubat**: **military** 1× 2014
- Ministers advised Shivaji but did **not** hold independent charge (A true, R false) 1× 1997
- Not a silver coin: **ruka** 1× 2016
- Protection levy: **chauth** 1× 2018

Ashtapradhan	Duty
Peshwa	Prime minister
Amatya (Majumdar)	Finance
Sachiv	Correspondence
Mantri (Waqianavis)	Records, intelligence
Sar-i-Naubat	Army
Sumant (Dabir)	Foreign affairs
Panditrao	Religion
Nyayadhish	Justice

24.3 Successors and Peshwas

- Order: **Sambhaji, Rajaram, Shivaji II, Shahu** 1× 2005
- At Aurangzeb's death the leader was **Tarabai** 3× 2008, 2012, 2013
- Peshwa order: **Balaji Vishwanath, Baji Rao I, Balaji Baji Rao, Madhav Rao I** 2× 2004, 2025
- Order: **Balaji Vishwanath, Baji Rao I, Madhav Rao I, Narayan Rao** 1× 2023
- Order: **Balaji Vishwanath, Balaji Baji Rao, Narayan Rao, Raghunath Rao** 1× 2024
- By 1750 a confederacy under the Peshwa (A and R true, R explains A) 1× 1997
- Peshwa became the real ruler under **Balaji Baji Rao** 1× 2007
- Strongest native power after the Mughals, but the reason over-claims (A true, R false) 1× 2016

24.4 Third Panipat

- Marathas lost to the **Afghans** 3× 1993, 1994, 2012
- Fought between **Marathas and Ahmad Shah Abdali** 1× 2004
- Abdali's Rohilla confidant: **Najib Khan** 1× 2006

MARATHA TIMELINE

1674 — Shivaji crowned at Raigarh
↓
1689 — Sambhaji executed
↓
1700-07 — Tarabai leads the war
↓
1713 — Balaji Vishwanath first Peshwa
↓
1761 — Third Panipat (Balaji Baji Rao's time)

TRAP ALERT

- Chauth = **one-fourth** (protection); sardeshmukhi = **one-tenth**.
- Shahu ruled **after** Rajaram and Shivaji II (he was a Mughal prisoner).
- Balaji Vishwanath (first Peshwa) is not Balaji Baji Rao (Panipat).

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

UP LINK

UP link: the Marathas raided the **Doab** and **Rohilkhand**; **Najib Khan** of the Rohillas (Najibabad, Bijnor) and **Shuja-ud-Daula** of **Awadh** sided with Abdali at Third Panipat; Shivaji escaped from **Agra** in 1666.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Shivaji crowned 1674 at Raigarh
2. Afzal Khan (Bijapur) 1659; Salher victory
3. Ashtapradhan = eight ministers
4. Chauth = protection; sardeshmukhi = hereditary 10%
5. Sambhaji, Rajaram, Shivaji II, Shahu
6. Tarabai led after 1700
7. Balaji Vishwanath, Baji Rao I, Balaji Baji Rao, Madhav Rao I
8. Peshwa supreme under Balaji Baji Rao
9. Third Panipat 1761: Abdali (Afghans)
10. Najib Khan = Rohilla ally of Abdali

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Chapter 25

Disintegration of the Mughal Empire

Built from 15 UPPSC questions (2004–2023). Focus: the later Mughals in order, Farrukhsiyar's farman and the Sayyid brothers, Muhammad Shah and Nadir Shah, the last emperors, Awadh and Hyderabad, Sawai Jai Singh.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

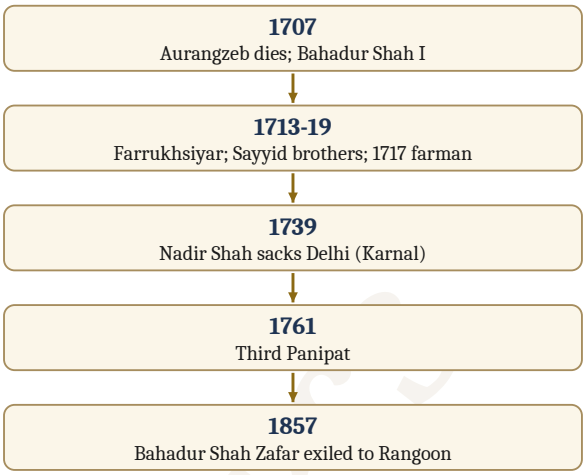
- **Later Mughals**: **Bahadur Shah I, Jahandar Shah, Farrukhsiyar, Muhammad Shah, Ahmad Shah, Alamgir II** 3× 2012, 2018, 2023
- **Farrukhsiyar's farman (1717)**: duty-free trade for the English in Bengal; **Sayyid brothers** = kingmakers 2× 2010, 2017
- **Nadir Shah** (1739) attacked under **Muhammad Shah**; tappa music grew at his court 3× 2004, 2004, 2023
- **Saadat Khan** = first Nawab of **Awadh**; **Chin Qilich Khan** founded **Hyderabad** 3× 2008, 2011, 2023

■ asked 3 or more times · asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

25.1 Later Mughals

- Aurangzeb's successor: **Bahadur Shah I** 1× 2012
- Order: **Bahadur Shah, Jahandar Shah, Farrukhsiyar, Muhammad Shah** 1× 2023
- Order: **Jahandar Shah, Muhammad Shah, Ahmad Shah, Alamgir II** 1× 2018
- Duty-free trade to the English in Bengal: **Farrukhsiyar** 1× 2010
- Kingmakers: **Hussain Ali and Abdullah** (Sayyid brothers) 1× 2017
- Nadir Shah's attack: under **Muhammad Shah** 1× 2004
- Eunuchs and ladies ruled under **Muhammad Shah** 1× 2004
- **Tappa** music refined at **Muhammad Shah's** court 1× 2023
- Bahadur Shah Zafar's father: **Akbar Shah II** 1× 2005
- Not correct of Zafar: pension **under one lakh** 1× 2006

DECLINE OF THE MUGHALS



25.2 Successor States and Jai Singh

- First Nawab of Awadh: **Saadat Khan** (Burhan-ul-Mulk) 1× 2008
- Saadat Khan founded Awadh and joined the plot against the Sayyids (both) 1× 2023
- Founder of Hyderabad: **Chin Qilich Khan** (Nizam-ul-Mulk) 1× 2011
- **Jantar Mantar**, Delhi: **Jai Singh II** 1× 2005
- Jai Singh's observatories: **Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain, Varanasi** (and Mathura) 1× 2007

Successor state	Founder
Awadh	Saadat Khan (1722)
Hyderabad	Nizam-ul-Mulk Chin Qilich Khan (1724)
Bengal	Murshid Quli Khan (1717)
Rohilkhand	Ali Muhammad Khan

TRAP ALERT

- Order: Bahadur Shah I, **Jahandar Shah**, Farrukhsiyar, Muhammad Shah.
- Nadir Shah = **Muhammad Shah** (1739); Abdali = 1748-1761.
- First Nawab of Awadh = **Saadat Khan**, not Safdar Jang.
- No Mughal is called "Akbar Shah I"; Zafar's father was **Akbar II**.

UP LINK

UP link: **Awadh** grew from Saadat Khan's governorship (capital Faizabad, later **Lucknow** under Asaf-ud-Daula); Jai Singh's observatory at **Varanasi** (Man Mahal) still stands.

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Bahadur Shah I succeeded Aurangzeb
2. Jahandar, Farrukhsiyar, Muhammad Shah, Ahmad Shah, Alamgir II
3. Farrukhsiyar = 1717 farman
4. Sayyid brothers = kingmakers
5. Nadir Shah 1739 under Muhammad Shah
6. Muhammad Shah = Rangeela; tappa
7. Akbar II = Zafar's father
8. Saadat Khan = first Nawab of Awadh
9. Chin Qilich Khan = Hyderabad
10. Jai Singh II = Jantar Mantar (Delhi, Varanasi too)

QUANTUM IAS & PCS